

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent Application Publication

20250280238

Kind Code

A1

Publication Date

September 04, 2025

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ROUTINES FOR PLAYBACK DEVICES

Abstract

A control device receives one or more first user inputs associating a particular playback mode with one or more playback devices and one or more user-defined acoustic parameters for particular media content that is associated with the particular playback mode. The control device associates a particular trigger condition with the particular playback mode. The particular trigger condition comprises a condition that causes the particular playback mode to be executed. The control device receives one or more second user inputs to activate a particular routine that is associated with the particular playback mode. After receiving the one or more second user inputs, the control device transmits a message that causes the one or more playback devices to play back the particular media content according to the one or more user-defined acoustic parameters.

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Family ID: 85721751

Appl. No.: 19/080603

Filed: March 14, 2025

Related U.S. Application Data

parent US continuation 17953900 20220927 parent-grant-document US 12284498 child US 19080603

us-provisional-application US 63261823 20210929

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: H04R3/12 (20060101); G06F3/16 (20060101); H04R27/00 (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC **H04R3/12** (20130101); **G06F3/165** (20130101); **H04R27/00** (20130101);
H04R2227/003 (20130101); H04R2227/005 (20130101); H04R2420/07 (20130101)

Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS [0001] This application claims the benefit of and priority to U.S. Non-Provisional application Ser. No. 17/953,900 filed Sep. 27, 2022, which claims benefit of and priority to U.S. Provisional Patent Application Ser. No. 63/261,823 filed on Sep. 29, 2021, and entitled “ROUTINES FOR PLAYBACK DEVICES,” which applications are expressly incorporated herein by reference in their entirety.

FIELD OF THE DISCLOSURE

[0002] The present disclosure is related to consumer goods and, more particularly, to methods, systems, products, features, services, and other elements directed to media playback or some aspect thereof.

BACKGROUND

[0003] Options for accessing and listening to digital audio in an out-loud setting were limited until in 2002, when SONOS, Inc. began development of a new type of playback system. Sonos then filed one of its first patent applications in 2003, entitled “Method for Synchronizing Audio Playback between Multiple Networked Devices,” and began offering its first media playback systems for sale in 2005. The Sonos Wireless Home Sound System enables people to experience music from many sources via one or more networked playback devices. Through a software control application installed on a controller (e.g., smartphone, tablet, computer, voice input device), one can play what she wants in any room having a networked playback device. Media content (e.g., songs, podcasts, video sound) can be streamed to playback devices such that each room with a playback device can play back corresponding different media content. In addition, rooms can be grouped together for synchronous playback of the same media content, and/or the same media content can be heard in all rooms synchronously.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0004] Features, aspects, and advantages of the presently disclosed technology may be better understood with regard to the following description, appended claims, and accompanying drawings, as listed below. A person skilled in the relevant art will understand that the features shown in the drawings are for purposes of illustrations, and variations, including different and/or additional features and arrangements thereof, are possible.

[0005] FIG. 1A is a partial cutaway view of an environment having a media playback system configured in accordance with aspects of the disclosed technology.

[0006] FIG. 1B is a schematic diagram of the media playback system of FIG. 1A and one or more networks.

[0007] FIG. 1C is a block diagram of a playback device.

[0008] FIG. 1D is a block diagram of a playback device.

[0009] FIG. 1E is a block diagram of a network microphone device.

[0010] FIG. 1F is a block diagram of a network microphone device.

[0011] FIG. 1G is a block diagram of a playback device.

[0012] FIG. 1H is a partial schematic diagram of a control device.

[0013] FIGS. 1I through 1L are schematic diagrams of corresponding media playback system zones.

[0014] FIG. 1M is a schematic diagram of media playback system areas.

[0015] FIG. 2A is a front isometric view of a playback device configured in accordance with aspects of the disclosed technology.

[0016] FIG. 2B is a front isometric view of the playback device of FIG. 3A without a grille.

[0017] FIG. 2C is an exploded view of the playback device of FIG. 2A.

[0018] FIG. 3A is a front view of a network microphone device configured in accordance with aspects of the disclosed technology.

[0019] FIG. 3B is a side isometric view of the network microphone device of FIG. 3A.

[0020] FIG. 3C is an exploded view of the network microphone device of FIGS. 3A and 3B.

[0021] FIG. 3D is an enlarged view of a portion of FIG. 3B.

[0022] FIG. 3E is a block diagram of the network microphone device of FIGS. 3A-3D

[0023] FIG. 3F is a schematic diagram of an example voice input.

[0024] FIGS. 4A-4D are schematic diagrams of a control device in various stages of operation in accordance with aspects of the disclosed technology.

[0025] FIG. 5 is front view of a control device.

[0026] FIG. 6 is a message flow diagram of a media playback system.

[0027] FIG. 7 is a schematic of a timeline associated with a playback device in accordance with aspects of the disclosed technology.

[0028] FIGS. 8A and 8B are schematic diagrams of a user interface of a playback device configured in accordance with aspects of the disclosed technology.

[0029] FIGS. 9A and 9B are schematic diagrams of a user interface of a control device configured in accordance with aspects of the disclosed technology.

[0030] FIGS. 10A and 10B are schematic diagrams of a user interface of a control device configured in accordance with aspects of the disclosed technology.

[0031] FIGS. 11A and 11B are schematic diagrams of a user interface of a control device configured in accordance with aspects of the disclosed technology.

[0032] FIGS. 12A and 12B are schematic diagrams of a user interface of a control device configured in accordance with aspects of the disclosed technology.

[0033] FIGS. 13A and 13B are schematic diagrams of a user interface of a control device configured in accordance with aspects of the disclosed technology.

[0034] FIG. 14 is a schematic diagram of a user interface of a control device configured in accordance with aspects of the disclosed technology.

[0035] FIGS. 15A and 15B are schematic diagrams of a user interface of a control device configured in accordance with aspects of the disclosed technology.

[0036] FIG. 16 is schematic diagram of media playback system in communication with cloud services.

[0037] FIGS. 17A-17C are message flow diagrams of a media playback system in communication with cloud services.

[0038] FIG. 18 shows a schematic diagram of a media playback system. in communication with cloud services

[0039] FIG. 19 shows a flow diagram for operating a playback device within a playback mode.

[0040] FIG. 20 shows a flow diagram for configuring a playback mode at a control device.

[0041] The drawings are for the purpose of illustrating example embodiments, but those of ordinary skill in the art will understand that the technology disclosed herein is not limited to the arrangements and/or instrumentality shown in the drawings.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

I. Overview

[0042] Embodiments described herein relate to the execution of routines for controlling one or

more playback devices. A particular set of routines may be used to define an operating mode of the one or more playback devices. The operating mode may be associated with a trigger condition that when met causes the one or more playback devices to behave in a way that is defined by the particular set of routines.

[0043] The routines may be executed or encoded at a playback device, at a control device, at a server, at another device, or at any combination thereof. Further, the routines may be partially encoded prior to being sent to the one or more playback devices for final execution. The routines may cause one or more playback devices to collaboratively perform a function. When the routines utilize multiple playback devices, the multiple playback devices may perform the exact same functions or may perform different functions.

[0044] In some embodiments, for example, a playback device comprises a communication interface, at least one processor; and at least one non-transitory computer-readable medium comprising program instructions that are executable by the at least one processor such that the playback device is configured to perform one or more acts. For example, after receiving an operating mode indication, the program instructions cause the playback device to operate within a particular operating mode that is selected from a plurality of operating modes. Each operating mode within the plurality of operating modes causes the playback device to operate in a different configuration. The program instructions cause the playback device to access a particular set of routines that is associated with the particular operating mode. The particular set of routines comprise one or more routines that cause the playback device to play one or more audio files in a particular manner. Additionally, the particular set of routines comprise one or more user interface interactions configured to cause the playback device to advance between the one or more routines within the particular set of routines. Additionally, the program instructions cause the playback device to map the one or more user interface interactions to a user interface associated with the playback device. Further the program instructions cause the playback device to execute at least one routine selected from the one or more routines.

[0045] Additionally, in some embodiments a control device comprises a communication interface, at least one processor, and at least one non-transitory computer-readable medium comprising program instructions that are executable by the at least one processor such that the playback device is configured to perform one or more acts. For example, the program instructions cause the control device to receive through the configuration interface a user input associating a particular routine with a particular playback device. The particular routine comprises instructions that are configured to cause the particular playback device to play one or more audio files. Additionally, the particular routine comprises one or more audio variables that configure the particular playback device to play the one or more audio files in a particular manner. The program instructions also cause the control device to associate a particular trigger condition with the particular routine. The particular trigger condition comprises a condition that causes the particular routine to be executed. Further, the computer instructions cause the control device to transmit the particular routine to a server.

[0046] While some examples described herein may refer to functions performed by given actors such as “users,” “listeners,” and/or other entities, it should be understood that this is for purposes of explanation only. The claims should not be interpreted to require action by any such example actor unless explicitly required by the language of the claims themselves.

[0047] In the Figures, identical reference numbers identify generally similar, and/or identical, elements. To facilitate the discussion of any particular element, the most significant digit or digits of a reference number refers to the Figure in which that element is first introduced. For example, element **110a** is first introduced and discussed with reference to FIG. 1A. Many of the details, dimensions, angles, and other features shown in the Figures are merely illustrative of particular embodiments of the disclosed technology. Accordingly, other embodiments can have other details, dimensions, angles and features without departing from the spirit or scope of the disclosure. In addition, those of ordinary skill in the art will appreciate that further embodiments of the various

disclosed technologies can be practiced without several of the details described below.

II. Suitable Operating Environment

[0048] FIG. 1A is a partial cutaway view of a media playback system **100** distributed in an environment **101** (e.g., a house). The media playback system **100** comprises one or more playback devices **110** (identified individually as playback devices **110a-n**), one or more network microphone devices **120** (“NMDs”) (identified individually as NMDs **120a-c**), and one or more control devices **130** (identified individually as control devices **130a** and **130b**).

[0049] As used herein the term “playback device” can generally refer to a network device configured to receive, process, and output data of a media playback system. For example, a playback device can be a network device that receives and processes audio content. In some embodiments, a playback device includes one or more transducers or speakers powered by one or more amplifiers. In other embodiments, however, a playback device includes one of (or neither of) the speaker and the amplifier. For instance, a playback device can comprise one or more amplifiers configured to drive one or more speakers external to the playback device via a corresponding wire or cable.

[0050] Moreover, as used herein the term “NMD” (i.e., a “network microphone device”) can generally refer to a network device that is configured for audio detection. In some embodiments, an NMD is a stand-alone device configured primarily for audio detection. In other embodiments, an NMD is incorporated into a playback device (or vice versa).

[0051] The term “control device” can generally refer to a network device configured to perform functions relevant to facilitating user access, control, and/or configuration of the media playback system **100**.

[0052] Each of the playback devices **110** is configured to receive audio signals or data from one or more media sources (e.g., one or more remote servers, one or more local devices) and play back the received audio signals or data as sound. The one or more NMDs **120** are configured to receive spoken word commands, and the one or more control devices **130** are configured to receive user input. In response to the received spoken word commands and/or user input, the media playback system **100** can play back audio via one or more of the playback devices **110**. In certain embodiments, the playback devices **110** are configured to commence playback of media content in response to a trigger. For instance, one or more of the playback devices **110** can be configured to play back a morning playlist upon detection of an associated trigger condition (e.g., presence of a user in a kitchen, detection of a coffee machine operation). In some embodiments, for example, the media playback system **100** is configured to play back audio from a first playback device (e.g., the playback device **100a**) in synchrony with a second playback device (e.g., the playback device **100b**). Interactions between the playback devices **110**, NMDs **120**, and/or control devices **130** of the media playback system **100** configured in accordance with the various embodiments of the disclosure are described in greater detail below with respect to FIGS. 1B-6.

[0053] In the illustrated embodiment of FIG. 1A, the environment **101** comprises a household having several rooms, spaces, and/or playback zones, including (clockwise from upper left) a master bathroom **101a**, a master bedroom **101b**, a second bedroom **101c**, a family room or den **101d**, an office **101e**, a living room **101f**, a dining room **101g**, a kitchen **101h**, and an outdoor patio **101i**. While certain embodiments and examples are described below in the context of a home environment, the technologies described herein may be implemented in other types of environments. In some embodiments, for example, the media playback system **100** can be implemented in one or more commercial settings (e.g., a restaurant, mall, airport, hotel, a retail or other store), one or more vehicles (e.g., a sports utility vehicle, bus, car, a ship, a boat, an airplane), multiple environments (e.g., a combination of home and vehicle environments), and/or another suitable environment where multi-zone audio may be desirable.

[0054] The media playback system **100** can comprise one or more playback zones, some of which may correspond to the rooms in the environment **101**. The media playback system **100** can be

established with one or more playback zones, after which additional zones may be added, or removed, to form, for example, the configuration shown in FIG. 1A. Each zone may be given a name according to a different room or space such as the office **101e**, master bathroom **101a**, master bedroom **101b**, the second bedroom **101c**, kitchen **101h**, dining room **101g**, living room **101f**, and/or the balcony **101i**. In some aspects, a single playback zone may include multiple rooms or spaces. In certain aspects, a single room or space may include multiple playback zones.

[0055] In the illustrated embodiment of FIG. 1A, the master bathroom **101a**, the second bedroom **101c**, the office **101e**, the living room **101f**, the dining room **101g**, the kitchen **101h**, and the outdoor patio **101i** each include one playback device **110**, and the master bedroom **101b** and the den **101d** include a plurality of playback devices **110**. In the master bedroom **101b**, the playback devices **110l** and **110m** may be configured, for example, to play back audio content in synchrony as individual ones of playback devices **110**, as a bonded playback zone, as a consolidated playback device, and/or any combination thereof. Similarly, in the den **101d**, the playback devices **110h-j** can be configured, for instance, to play back audio content in synchrony as individual ones of playback devices **110**, as one or more bonded playback devices, and/or as one or more consolidated playback devices. Additional details regarding bonded and consolidated playback devices are described below with respect to FIGS. 1B and 1E-1M.

[0056] In some aspects, one or more of the playback zones in the environment **101** may each be playing different audio content. For instance, a user may be grilling on the patio **101i** and listening to hip hop music being played by the playback device **110c** while another user is preparing food in the kitchen **101h** and listening to classical music played by the playback device **110b**. In another example, a playback zone may play the same audio content in synchrony with another playback zone. For instance, the user may be in the office **101e** listening to the playback device **110f** playing back the same hip-hop music being played back by playback device **110c** on the patio **101i**. In some aspects, the playback devices **110c** and **110f** play back the hip hop music in synchrony such that the user perceives that the audio content is being played seamlessly (or at least substantially seamlessly) while moving between different playback zones. Additional details regarding audio playback synchronization among playback devices and/or zones can be found, for example, in U.S. Pat. No. 8,234,395 entitled, “System and method for synchronizing operations among a plurality of independently clocked digital data processing devices,” which is incorporated herein by reference in its entirety.

a. Suitable Media Playback System

[0057] FIG. 1B is a schematic diagram of the media playback system **100** and a cloud network **102**. For ease of illustration, certain devices of the media playback system **100** and the cloud network **102** are omitted from FIG. 1B. One or more communication links **103** (referred to hereinafter as “the links **103**”) communicatively couple the media playback system **100** and the cloud network **102**.

[0058] The links **103** can comprise, for example, one or more wired networks, one or more wireless networks, one or more wide area networks (WAN), one or more local area networks (LAN), one or more personal area networks (PAN), one or more telecommunication networks (e.g., one or more Global System for Mobiles (GSM) networks, Code Division Multiple Access (CDMA) networks, Long-Term Evolution (LTE) networks, 5G communication network networks, and/or other suitable data transmission protocol networks), etc. The cloud network **102** is configured to deliver media content (e.g., audio content, video content, photographs, social media content) to the media playback system **100** in response to a request transmitted from the media playback system **100** via the links **103**. In some embodiments, the cloud network **102** is further configured to receive data (e.g., voice input data) from the media playback system **100** and correspondingly transmit commands and/or media content to the media playback system **100**.

[0059] The cloud network **102** comprises computing devices **106** (identified separately as a first computing device **106a**, a second computing device **106b**, and a third computing device **106c**). The

computing devices **106** can comprise individual computers or servers, such as, for example, a media streaming service server storing audio and/or other media content, a voice service server, a social media server, a media playback system control server, etc. In some embodiments, one or more of the computing devices **106** comprise modules of a single computer or server. In certain embodiments, one or more of the computing devices **106** comprise one or more modules, computers, and/or servers. Moreover, while the cloud network **102** is described above in the context of a single cloud network, in some embodiments the cloud network **102** comprises a plurality of cloud networks comprising communicatively coupled computing devices. Furthermore, while the cloud network **102** is shown in FIG. **1B** as having three of the computing devices **106**, in some embodiments, the cloud network **102** comprises fewer (or more than) three computing devices **106**.

[0060] The media playback system **100** is configured to receive media content from the networks **102** via the links **103**. The received media content can comprise, for example, a Uniform Resource Identifier (URI) and/or a Uniform Resource Locator (URL). For instance, in some examples, the media playback system **100** can stream, download, or otherwise obtain data from a URI or a URL corresponding to the received media content. A network **104** communicatively couples the links **103** and at least a portion of the devices (e.g., one or more of the playback devices **110**, NMDs **120**, and/or control devices **130**) of the media playback system **100**. The network **104** can include, for example, a wireless network (e.g., a WiFi network, a Bluetooth, a Z-Wave network, a ZigBee, and/or other suitable wireless communication protocol network) and/or a wired network (e.g., a network comprising Ethernet, Universal Serial Bus (USB), and/or another suitable wired communication). As those of ordinary skill in the art will appreciate, as used herein, “WiFi” can refer to several different communication protocols including, for example, Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers (IEEE) 802.11a, 802.11b, 802.11g, 802.11n, 802.11ac, 802.11ad, 802.11af, 802.11ah, 802.11ai, 802.11aj, 802.11aq, 802.11ax, 802.11ay, 802.15, etc. transmitted at 2.4 Gigahertz (GHz), 5 GHz, and/or another suitable frequency.

[0061] In some embodiments, the network **104** comprises a dedicated communication network that the media playback system **100** uses to transmit messages between individual devices and/or to transmit media content to and from media content sources (e.g., one or more of the computing devices **106**). In certain embodiments, the network **104** is configured to be accessible only to devices in the media playback system **100**, thereby reducing interference and competition with other household devices. In other embodiments, however, the network **104** comprises an existing household communication network (e.g., a household WiFi network). In some embodiments, the links **103** and the network **104** comprise one or more of the same networks. In some aspects, for example, the links **103** and the network **104** comprise a telecommunication network (e.g., an LTE network, a 5G network). Moreover, in some embodiments, the media playback system **100** is implemented without the network **104**, and devices comprising the media playback system **100** can communicate with each other, for example, via one or more direct connections, PANs, telecommunication networks, and/or other suitable communication links. The network **104** may be referred to herein as a “local communication network” to differentiate the network **104** from the cloud network **102** that couples the media playback system **100** to remote devices, such as cloud services.

[0062] In some embodiments, audio content sources may be regularly added or removed from the media playback system **100**. In some embodiments, for example, the media playback system **100** performs an indexing of media items when one or more media content sources are updated, added to, and/or removed from the media playback system **100**. The media playback system **100** can scan identifiable media items in some or all folders and/or directories accessible to the playback devices **110** and generate or update a media content database comprising metadata (e.g., title, artist, album, track length) and other associated information (e.g., URIs, URLs) for each identifiable media item found. In some embodiments, for example, the media content database is stored on one or more of

the playback devices **110**, network microphone devices **120**, and/or control devices **130**.

[0063] In the illustrated embodiment of FIG. **1B**, the playback devices **110l** and **110m** comprise a group **107a**. The playback devices **110l** and **110m** can be positioned in different rooms in a household and be grouped together in the group **107a** on a temporary or permanent basis based on user input received at the control device **130a** and/or another control device **130** in the media playback system **100**. When arranged in the group **107a**, the playback devices **110l** and **110m** can be configured to play back the same or similar audio content in synchrony from one or more audio content sources. In certain embodiments, for example, the group **107a** comprises a bonded zone in which the playback devices **110l** and **110m** comprise left audio and right audio channels, respectively, of multi-channel audio content, thereby producing or enhancing a stereo effect of the audio content. In some embodiments, the group **107a** includes additional playback devices **110**. In other embodiments, however, the media playback system **100** omits the group **107a** and/or other grouped arrangements of the playback devices **110**. Additional details regarding groups and other arrangements of playback devices are described in further detail below with respect to FIGS. **1-I** through **IM**.

[0064] The media playback system **100** includes the NMDs **120a** and **120d**, each comprising one or more microphones configured to receive voice utterances from a user. In the illustrated embodiment of FIG. **1B**, the NMD **120a** is a standalone device and the NMD **120d** is integrated into the playback device **110n**. The NMD **120a**, for example, is configured to receive voice input **121** from a user **123**. In some embodiments, the NMD **120a** transmits data associated with the received voice input **121** to a voice assistant service (VAS) configured to (i) process the received voice input data and (ii) facilitate one or more operations on behalf of the media playback system **100**.

[0065] In some aspects, for example, the computing device **106c** comprises one or more modules and/or servers of a VAS (e.g., a VAS operated by one or more of SONOS®, AMAZON®, GOOGLE®, APPLE®, MICROSOFT®). The computing device **106c** can receive the voice input data from the NMD **120a** via the network **104** and the links **103**.

[0066] In response to receiving the voice input data, the computing device **106c** processes the voice input data (i.e., “Play Hey Jude by The Beatles”), and determines that the processed voice input includes a command to play a song (e.g., “Hey Jude”). In some embodiments, after processing the voice input, the computing device **106c** accordingly transmits commands to the media playback system **100** to play back “Hey Jude” by the Beatles from a suitable media service (e.g., via one or more of the computing devices **106**) on one or more of the playback devices **110**. In other embodiments, the computing device **106c** may be configured to interface with media services on behalf of the media playback system **100**. In such embodiments, after processing the voice input, instead of the computing device **106c** transmitting commands to the media playback system **100** causing the media playback system **100** to retrieve the requested media from a suitable media service, the computing device **106c** itself causes a suitable media service to provide the requested media to the media playback system **100** in accordance with the user's voice utterance.

b. Suitable Playback Devices

[0067] FIG. **1C** is a block diagram of the playback device **110a** comprising an input/output **111** (also referred to herein as a “communication interface”). The input/output **111** can include an analog I/O **111a** (e.g., one or more wires, cables, and/or other suitable communication links configured to carry analog signals) and/or a digital I/O **111b** (e.g., one or more wires, cables, or other suitable communication links configured to carry digital signals). In some embodiments, the analog I/O **111a** is an audio line-in input connection comprising, for example, an auto-detecting 3.5 mm audio line-in connection. In some embodiments, the digital I/O **111b** comprises a Sony/Philips Digital Interface Format (S/PDIF) communication interface and/or cable and/or a Toshiba Link (TOSLINK) cable. In some embodiments, the digital I/O **111b** comprises a High-Definition Multimedia Interface (HDMI) interface and/or cable. In some embodiments, the digital I/O **111b**

includes one or more wireless communication links comprising, for example, a radio frequency (RF), infrared, WiFi, Bluetooth, or another suitable communication protocol. In certain embodiments, the analog I/O **111a** and the digital **111b** comprise interfaces (e.g., ports, plugs, jacks) configured to receive connectors of cables transmitting analog and digital signals, respectively, without necessarily including cables.

[0068] The playback device **110a**, for example, can receive media content (e.g., audio content comprising music and/or other sounds) from a local audio source **105** via the input/output **111** (e.g., a cable, a wire, a PAN, a Bluetooth connection, an ad hoc wired or wireless communication network, and/or another suitable communication link). The local audio source **105** can comprise, for example, a mobile device (e.g., a smartphone, a tablet, a laptop computer) or another suitable audio component (e.g., a television, a desktop computer, an amplifier, a phonograph, a Blu-ray player, a memory storing digital media files). In some aspects, the local audio source **105** includes local music libraries on a smartphone, a computer, a networked-attached storage (NAS), and/or another suitable device configured to store media files. In certain embodiments, one or more of the playback devices **110**, NMDs **120**, and/or control devices **130** comprise the local audio source **105**. In other embodiments, however, the media playback system omits the local audio source **105** altogether. In some embodiments, the playback device **110a** does not include an input/output **111** and receives all audio content via the network **104**.

[0069] The playback device **110a** further comprises electronics **112**, a user interface **113** (e.g., one or more buttons, knobs, dials, touch-sensitive surfaces, displays, touchscreens), and one or more transducers **114** (referred to hereinafter as “the transducers **114**”). The electronics **112** are configured to receive audio from an audio source (e.g., the local audio source **105**) via the input/output **111** or one or more of the computing devices **106a-c** via the network **104** (FIG. 1B), amplify the received audio, and output the amplified audio for playback via one or more of the transducers **114**. In some embodiments, the playback device **110a** optionally includes one or more microphones **115** (e.g., a single microphone, a plurality of microphones, a microphone array) (hereinafter referred to as “the microphones **115**”). In certain embodiments, for example, the playback device **110a** having one or more of the optional microphones **115** can operate as an NMD configured to receive voice input from a user and correspondingly perform one or more operations based on the received voice input.

[0070] In the illustrated embodiment of FIG. 1C, the electronics **112** comprise one or more processors **112a** (referred to hereinafter as “the processors **112a**”), memory **112b**, software components **112c**, a network interface **112d**, one or more audio processing components **112g** (referred to hereinafter as “the audio components **112g**”), one or more audio amplifiers **112h** (referred to hereinafter as “the amplifiers **112h**”), and power **112i** (e.g., one or more power supplies, power cables, power receptacles, batteries, induction coils, Power-over Ethernet (POE) interfaces, and/or other suitable sources of electric power). In some embodiments, the electronics **112** optionally include one or more other components **112j** (e.g., one or more sensors, video displays, touchscreens, battery charging bases).

[0071] The processors **112a** can comprise clock-driven computing component(s) configured to process data, and the memory **112b** can comprise a computer-readable medium (e.g., a tangible, non-transitory computer-readable medium loaded with one or more of the software components **112c**) configured to store instructions for performing various operations and/or functions. The processors **112a** are configured to execute the instructions stored on the memory **112b** to perform one or more of the operations. The operations can include, for example, causing the playback device **110a** to retrieve audio data from an audio source (e.g., one or more of the computing devices **106a-c** (FIG. 1B)), and/or another one of the playback devices **110**. In some embodiments, the operations further include causing the playback device **110a** to send audio data to another one of the playback devices **110a** and/or another device (e.g., one of the NMDs **120**). Certain embodiments include operations causing the playback device **110a** to pair with another of the one

or more playback devices **110** to enable a multi-channel audio environment (e.g., a stereo pair, a bonded zone).

[0072] The processors **112a** can be further configured to perform operations causing the playback device **110a** to synchronize playback of audio content with another of the one or more playback devices **110**. As those of ordinary skill in the art will appreciate, during synchronous playback of audio content on a plurality of playback devices, a listener will preferably be unable to perceive time-delay differences between playback of the audio content by the playback device **110a** and the other one or more other playback devices **110**. Additional details regarding audio playback synchronization among playback devices can be found, for example, in U.S. Pat. No. 8,234,395, which was incorporated by reference above.

[0073] In some embodiments, the memory **112b** is further configured to store data associated with the playback device **110a**, such as one or more zones and/or zone groups of which the playback device **110a** is a member, audio sources accessible to the playback device **110a**, and/or a playback queue that the playback device **110a** (and/or another of the one or more playback devices) can be associated with. The stored data can comprise one or more state variables that are periodically updated and used to describe a state of the playback device **110a**. The memory **112b** can also include data associated with a state of one or more of the other devices (e.g., the playback devices **110**, NMDs **120**, control devices **130**) of the media playback system **100**. In some aspects, for example, the state data is shared during predetermined intervals of time (e.g., every 5 seconds, every 10 seconds, every 60 seconds) among at least a portion of the devices of the media playback system **100**, so that one or more of the devices have the most recent data associated with the media playback system **100**.

[0074] The network interface **112d** is configured to facilitate a transmission of data between the playback device **110a** and one or more other devices on a data network such as, for example, the links **103** and/or the network **104** (FIG. 1B). The network interface **112d** is configured to transmit and receive data corresponding to media content (e.g., audio content, video content, text, photographs) and other signals (e.g., non-transitory signals) comprising digital packet data including an Internet Protocol (IP)-based source address and/or an IP-based destination address. The network interface **112d** can parse the digital packet data such that the electronics **112** properly receives and processes the data destined for the playback device **110a**.

[0075] In the illustrated embodiment of FIG. 1C, the network interface **112d** comprises one or more wireless interfaces **112e** (referred to hereinafter as “the wireless interface **112e**”). The wireless interface **112e** (e.g., a suitable interface comprising one or more antennae) can be configured to wirelessly communicate with one or more other devices (e.g., one or more of the other playback devices **110**, NMDs **120**, and/or control devices **130**) that are communicatively coupled to the network **104** (FIG. 1B) in accordance with a suitable wireless communication protocol (e.g., WiFi, Bluetooth, LTE). In some embodiments, the network interface **112d** optionally includes a wired interface **112f** (e.g., an interface or receptacle configured to receive a network cable such as an Ethernet, a USB-A, USB-C, and/or Thunderbolt cable) configured to communicate over a wired connection with other devices in accordance with a suitable wired communication protocol. In certain embodiments, the network interface **112d** includes the wired interface **112f** and excludes the wireless interface **112e**. In some embodiments, the electronics **112** excludes the network interface **112d** altogether and transmits and receives media content and/or other data via another communication path (e.g., the input/output **111**).

[0076] The audio components **112g** are configured to process and/or filter data comprising media content received by the electronics **112** (e.g., via the input/output **111** and/or the network interface **112d**) to produce output audio signals. In some embodiments, the audio processing components **112g** comprise, for example, one or more digital-to-analog converters (DAC), audio preprocessing components, audio enhancement components, a digital signal processors (DSPs), and/or other suitable audio processing components, modules, circuits, etc. In certain embodiments, one or more

of the audio processing components **112g** can comprise one or more subcomponents of the processors **112a**. In some embodiments, the electronics **112** omits the audio processing components **112g**. In some aspects, for example, the processors **112a** execute instructions stored on the memory **112b** to perform audio processing operations to produce the output audio signals.

[0077] The amplifiers **112h** are configured to receive and amplify the audio output signals produced by the audio processing components **112g** and/or the processors **112a**. The amplifiers **112h** can comprise electronic devices and/or components configured to amplify audio signals to levels sufficient for driving one or more of the transducers **114**. In some embodiments, for example, the amplifiers **112h** include one or more switching or class-D power amplifiers. In other embodiments, however, the amplifiers include one or more other types of power amplifiers (e.g., linear gain power amplifiers, class-A amplifiers, class-B amplifiers, class-AB amplifiers, class-C amplifiers, class-D amplifiers, class-E amplifiers, class-F amplifiers, class-G and/or class H amplifiers, and/or another suitable type of power amplifier). In certain embodiments, the amplifiers **112h** comprise a suitable combination of two or more of the foregoing types of power amplifiers. Moreover, in some embodiments, individual ones of the amplifiers **112h** correspond to individual ones of the transducers **114**. In other embodiments, however, the electronics **112** includes a single one of the amplifiers **112h** configured to output amplified audio signals to a plurality of the transducers **114**. In some other embodiments, the electronics **112** omits the amplifiers **112h**.

[0078] The transducers **114** (e.g., one or more speakers and/or speaker drivers) receive the amplified audio signals from the amplifier **112h** and render or output the amplified audio signals as sound (e.g., audible sound waves having a frequency between about 20 Hertz (Hz) and 20 kilohertz (kHz)). In some embodiments, the transducers **114** can comprise a single transducer. In other embodiments, however, the transducers **114** comprise a plurality of audio transducers. In some embodiments, the transducers **114** comprise more than one type of transducer. For example, the transducers **114** can include one or more low frequency transducers (e.g., subwoofers, woofers), mid-range frequency transducers (e.g., mid-range transducers, mid-woofers), and one or more high frequency transducers (e.g., one or more tweeters). As used herein, “low frequency” can generally refer to audible frequencies below about 500 Hz, “mid-range frequency” can generally refer to audible frequencies between about 500 Hz and about 2 kHz, and “high frequency” can generally refer to audible frequencies above 2 kHz. In certain embodiments, however, one or more of the transducers **114** comprise transducers that do not adhere to the foregoing frequency ranges. For example, one of the transducers **114** may comprise a mid-woofer transducer configured to output sound at frequencies between about 200 Hz and about 5 kHz.

[0079] By way of illustration, SONOS, Inc. presently offers (or has offered) for sale certain playback devices including, for example, a “SONOS ONE,” “PLAY:1,” “PLAY:3,” “PLAY:5,” “PLAYBAR,” “PLAYBASE,” “CONNECT:AMP,” “CONNECT,” and “SUB.” Other suitable playback devices may additionally or alternatively be used to implement the playback devices of example embodiments disclosed herein. Additionally, one of ordinary skilled in the art will appreciate that a playback device is not limited to the examples described herein or to SONOS product offerings. In some embodiments, for example, one or more playback devices **110** comprises wired or wireless headphones (e.g., over-the-ear headphones, on-ear headphones, in-ear earphones). In other embodiments, one or more of the playback devices **110** comprise a docking station and/or an interface configured to interact with a docking station for personal mobile media playback devices. In certain embodiments, a playback device may be integral to another device or component such as a television, a lighting fixture, or some other device for indoor or outdoor use. In some embodiments, a playback device omits a user interface and/or one or more transducers. For example, FIG. 1D is a block diagram of a playback device **110p** comprising the input/output **111** and electronics **112** without the user interface **113** or transducers **114**.

[0080] FIG. 1E is a block diagram of a bonded playback device **110q** comprising the playback device **110a** (FIG. 1C) sonically bonded with the playback device **110i** (e.g., a subwoofer) (FIG.

1A). In the illustrated embodiment, the playback devices **110a** and **110i** are separate ones of the playback devices **110** housed in separate enclosures. In some embodiments, however, the bonded playback device **110q** comprises a single enclosure housing both the playback devices **110a** and **110i**. The bonded playback device **110q** can be configured to process and reproduce sound differently than an unbonded playback device (e.g., the playback device **110a** of FIG. 1C) and/or paired or bonded playback devices (e.g., the playback devices **110l** and **110m** of FIG. 1B). In some embodiments, for example, the playback device **110a** is full-range playback device configured to render low frequency, mid-range frequency, and high frequency audio content, and the playback device **110i** is a subwoofer configured to render low frequency audio content. In some aspects, the playback device **110a**, when bonded with the first playback device, is configured to render only the mid-range and high frequency components of a particular audio content, while the playback device **110i** renders the low frequency component of the particular audio content. In some embodiments, the bonded playback device **110q** includes additional playback devices and/or another bonded playback device. Additional playback device embodiments are described in further detail below with respect to FIGS. 2A-3D.

c. Suitable Network Microphone Devices (NMDs)

[0081] FIG. 1F is a block diagram of the NMD **120a** (FIGS. 1A and 1B). The NMD **120a** includes one or more voice processing components **124** (hereinafter “the voice components **124**”) and several components described with respect to the playback device **110a** (FIG. 1C) including the processors **112a**, the memory **112b**, and the microphones **115**. The NMD **120a** optionally comprises other components also included in the playback device **110a** (FIG. 1C), such as the user interface **113** and/or the transducers **114**. In some embodiments, the NMD **120a** is configured as a media playback device (e.g., one or more of the playback devices **110**), and further includes, for example, one or more of the audio components **112g** (FIG. 1C), the amplifiers **114**, and/or other playback device components. In certain embodiments, the NMD **120a** comprises an Internet of Things (IoT) device such as, for example, a thermostat, alarm panel, fire and/or smoke detector, etc. In some embodiments, the NMD **120a** comprises the microphones **115**, the voice processing **124**, and only a portion of the components of the electronics **112** described above with respect to FIG. 1B. In some aspects, for example, the NMD **120a** includes the processor **112a** and the memory **112b** (FIG. 1B), while omitting one or more other components of the electronics **112**. In some embodiments, the NMD **120a** includes additional components (e.g., one or more sensors, cameras, thermometers, barometers, hygrometers).

[0082] In some embodiments, an NMD can be integrated into a playback device. FIG. 1G is a block diagram of a playback device **110r** comprising an NMD **120d**. The playback device **110r** can comprise many or all of the components of the playback device **110a** and further include the microphones **115** and voice processing **124** (FIG. 1F). The playback device **110r** optionally includes an integrated control device **130c**. The control device **130c** can comprise, for example, a user interface (e.g., the user interface **113** of FIG. 1B) configured to receive user input (e.g., touch input, voice input) without a separate control device. In other embodiments, however, the playback device **110r** receives commands from another control device (e.g., the control device **130a** of FIG. 1B). Additional NMD embodiments are described in further detail below with respect to FIGS. 3A-3F.

[0083] Referring again to FIG. 1F, the microphones **115** are configured to acquire, capture, and/or receive sound from an environment (e.g., the environment **101** of FIG. 1A) and/or a room in which the NMD **120a** is positioned. The received sound can include, for example, vocal utterances, audio played back by the NMD **120a** and/or another playback device, background voices, ambient sounds, etc. The microphones **115** convert the received sound into electrical signals to produce microphone data. The voice processing **124** receives and analyzes the microphone data to determine whether a voice input is present in the microphone data. The voice input can comprise, for example, an activation word followed by an utterance including a user request. As those of

ordinary skill in the art will appreciate, an activation word is a word or other audio cue signifying a user voice input. For instance, in querying the AMAZON® VAS, a user might speak the activation word “Alexa.” Other examples include “Ok, Google” for invoking the GOOGLE® VAS and “Hey, Siri” for invoking the APPLE® VAS.

[0084] After detecting the activation word, voice processing **124** monitors the microphone data for an accompanying user request in the voice input. The user request may include, for example, a command to control a third-party device, such as a thermostat (e.g., NEST® thermostat), an illumination device (e.g., a PHILIPS HUE® lighting device), or a media playback device (e.g., a Sonos® playback device). For example, a user might speak the activation word “Alexa” followed by the utterance “set the thermostat to **68** degrees” to set a temperature in a home (e.g., the environment **101** of FIG. 1A). The user might speak the same activation word followed by the utterance “turn on the living room” to turn on illumination devices in a living room area of the home. The user may similarly speak an activation word followed by a request to play a particular song, an album, or a playlist of music on a playback device in the home. Additional description regarding receiving and processing voice input data can be found in further detail below with respect to FIGS. 3A-3F.

d. Suitable Control Devices

[0085] FIG. 1H is a partial schematic diagram of the control device **130a** (FIGS. 1A and 1B). As used herein, the term “control device” can be used interchangeably with “controller” or “control system.” Among other features, the control device **130a** is configured to receive user input related to the media playback system **100** and, in response, cause one or more devices in the media playback system **100** to perform an action(s) or operation(s) corresponding to the user input. In the illustrated embodiment, the control device **130a** comprises a smartphone (e.g., an iPhone™, an Android phone) on which media playback system controller application software is installed. In some embodiments, the control device **130a** comprises, for example, a tablet (e.g., an iPad™), a computer (e.g., a laptop computer, a desktop computer), and/or another suitable device (e.g., a television, an automobile audio head unit, an IoT device). In certain embodiments, the control device **130a** comprises a dedicated controller for the media playback system **100**. In other embodiments, as described above with respect to FIG. 1G, the control device **130a** is integrated into another device in the media playback system **100** (e.g., one more of the playback devices **110**, NMDs **120**, and/or other suitable devices configured to communicate over a network).

[0086] The control device **130a** includes electronics **132**, a user interface **133**, one or more speakers **134**, and one or more microphones **135**. The electronics **132** comprise one or more processors **132a** (referred to hereinafter as “the processors **132a**”), a memory **132b**, software components **132c**, and a network interface **132d**. The processor **132a** can be configured to perform functions relevant to facilitating user access, control, and configuration of the media playback system **100**. The memory **132b** can comprise data storage that can be loaded with one or more of the software components executable by the processor **302** to perform those functions. The software components **132c** can comprise applications and/or other executable software configured to facilitate control of the media playback system **100**. The memory **112b** can be configured to store, for example, the software components **132c**, media playback system controller application software, and/or other data associated with the media playback system **100** and the user.

[0087] The network interface **132d** is configured to facilitate network communications between the control device **130a** and one or more other devices in the media playback system **100**, and/or one or more remote devices. In some embodiments, the network interface **132d** is configured to operate according to one or more suitable communication industry standards (e.g., infrared, radio, wired standards including IEEE 802.3, wireless standards including IEEE 802.11a, 802.11b, 802.11g, 802.11n, 802.11ac, 802.15, 4G, LTE). The network interface **132d** can be configured, for example, to transmit data to and/or receive data from the playback devices **110**, the NMDs **120**, other ones of the control devices **130**, one of the computing devices **106** of FIG. 1B, devices comprising one or

more other media playback systems, etc. The transmitted and/or received data can include, for example, playback device control commands, state variables, playback zone and/or zone group configurations. For instance, based on user input received at the user interface **133**, the network interface **132d** can transmit a playback device control command (e.g., volume control, audio playback control, audio content selection) from the control device **304** to one or more of the playback devices **110**. The network interface **132d** can also transmit and/or receive configuration changes such as, for example, adding/removing one or more playback devices **110** to/from a zone, adding/removing one or more zones to/from a zone group, forming a bonded or consolidated player, separating one or more playback devices from a bonded or consolidated player, among others. Additional description of zones and groups can be found below with respect to FIGS. **1-I** through **1M**.

[0088] The user interface **133** is configured to receive user input and can facilitate control of the media playback system **100**. The user interface **133** includes media content art **133a** (e.g., album art, lyrics, videos), a playback status indicator **133b** (e.g., an elapsed and/or remaining time indicator), media content information region **133c**, a playback control region **133d**, and a zone indicator **133e**. The media content information region **133c** can include a display of relevant information (e.g., title, artist, album, genre, release year) about media content currently playing and/or media content in a queue or playlist. The playback control region **133d** can include selectable (e.g., via touch input and/or via a cursor or another suitable selector) icons to cause one or more playback devices in a selected playback zone or zone group to perform playback actions such as, for example, play or pause, fast forward, rewind, skip to next, skip to previous, enter/exit shuffle mode, enter/exit repeat mode, enter/exit cross fade mode, etc. The playback control region **133d** may also include selectable icons to modify equalization settings, playback volume, and/or other suitable playback actions. In the illustrated embodiment, the user interface **133** comprises a display presented on a touch screen interface of a smartphone (e.g., an iPhone™, an Android phone). In some embodiments, however, user interfaces of varying formats, styles, and interactive sequences may alternatively be implemented on one or more network devices to provide comparable control access to a media playback system.

[0089] The one or more speakers **134** (e.g., one or more transducers) can be configured to output sound to the user of the control device **130a**. In some embodiments, the one or more speakers comprise individual transducers configured to correspondingly output low frequencies, mid-range frequencies, and/or high frequencies. In some aspects, for example, the control device **130a** is configured as a playback device (e.g., one of the playback devices **110**). Similarly, in some embodiments the control device **130a** is configured as an NMD (e.g., one of the NMDs **120**), receiving voice commands and other sounds via the one or more microphones **135**.

[0090] The one or more microphones **135** can comprise, for example, one or more condenser microphones, electret condenser microphones, dynamic microphones, and/or other suitable types of microphones or transducers. In some embodiments, two or more of the microphones **135** are arranged to capture location information of an audio source (e.g., voice, audible sound) and/or configured to facilitate filtering of background noise. Moreover, in certain embodiments, the control device **130a** is configured to operate as playback device and an NMD. In other embodiments, however, the control device **130a** omits the one or more speakers **134** and/or the one or more microphones **135**. For instance, the control device **130a** may comprise a device (e.g., a thermostat, an IoT device, a network device) comprising a portion of the electronics **132** and the user interface **133** (e.g., a touch screen) without any speakers or microphones. Additional control device embodiments are described in further detail below with respect to FIGS. **4A-4D** and **5**.

e. Suitable Playback Device Configurations

[0091] FIGS. **1I** through **1M** show example configurations of playback devices in zones and zone groups. Referring first to FIG. **1M**, in one example, a single playback device may belong to a zone. For example, the playback device **110g** in the second bedroom **101c** (FIG. **1A**) may belong to Zone

C. In some implementations described below, multiple playback devices may be “bonded” to form a “bonded pair” which together form a single zone. For example, the playback device **110l** (e.g., a left playback device) can be bonded to the playback device **110m** (e.g., a right playback device) to form Zone A. Bonded playback devices may have different playback responsibilities (e.g., channel responsibilities). In another implementation described below, multiple playback devices may be merged to form a single zone. For example, the playback device **110h** (e.g., a front playback device) may be merged with the playback device **110i** (e.g., a subwoofer), and the playback devices **110j** and **110k** (e.g., left and right surround speakers, respectively) to form a single Zone D. In another example, the playback devices **110g** and **110h** can be merged to form a merged group or a zone group **108b**. The merged playback devices **110g** and **110h** may not be specifically assigned different playback responsibilities. That is, the merged playback devices **110h** and **110i** may, aside from playing audio content in synchrony, each play audio content as they would if they were not merged.

[0092] Each zone in the media playback system **100** may be provided for control as a single user interface (UI) entity. For example, Zone A may be provided as a single entity named Master Bathroom. Zone B may be provided as a single entity named Master Bedroom. Zone C may be provided as a single entity named Second Bedroom.

[0093] Playback devices that are bonded may have different playback responsibilities, such as responsibilities for certain audio channels. For example, as shown in FIG. 1-I, the playback devices **110l** and **110m** may be bonded so as to produce or enhance a stereo effect of audio content. In this example, the playback device **110l** may be configured to play a left channel audio component, while the playback device **110m** may be configured to play a right channel audio component. In some implementations, such stereo bonding may be referred to as “pairing.”

[0094] Additionally, bonded playback devices may have additional and/or different respective speaker drivers. As shown in FIG. 1J, the playback device **110h** named Front may be bonded with the playback device **110i** named SUB. The Front device **110h** can be configured to render a range of mid to high frequencies and the SUB device **110i** can be configured to render low frequencies. When unbonded, however, the Front device **110h** can be configured to render a full range of frequencies. As another example, FIG. 1K shows the Front and SUB devices **110h** and **110i** further bonded with Left and Right playback devices **110j** and **110k**, respectively. In some implementations, the Right and Left devices **110j** and **110k** can be configured to form surround or “satellite” channels of a home theater system. The bonded playback devices **110h**, **110i**, **110j**, and **110k** may form a single Zone D (FIG. 1M).

[0095] Playback devices that are merged may not have assigned playback responsibilities and may each render the full range of audio content the respective playback device is capable of. Nevertheless, merged devices may be represented as a single UI entity (i.e., a zone, as discussed above). For instance, the playback devices **110a** and **110n** in the master bathroom have the single UI entity of Zone A. In one embodiment, the playback devices **110a** and **110n** may each output the full range of audio content each respective playback devices **110a** and **110n** are capable of, in synchrony.

[0096] In some embodiments, an NMD is bonded or merged with another device so as to form a zone. For example, the NMD **120b** may be bonded with the playback device **110e**, which together form Zone F, named Living Room. In other embodiments, a stand-alone network microphone device may be in a zone by itself. In other embodiments, however, a stand-alone network microphone device may not be associated with a zone. Additional details regarding associating network microphone devices and playback devices as designated or default devices may be found, for example, in previously referenced U.S. patent application Ser. No. 15/438,749.

[0097] Zones of individual, bonded, and/or merged devices may be grouped to form a zone group. For example, referring to FIG. 1M, Zone A may be grouped with Zone B to form a zone group **108a** that includes the two zones. Similarly, Zone G may be grouped with Zone H to form the zone

group **108b**. As another example, Zone A may be grouped with one or more other Zones C-I. The Zones A-I may be grouped and ungrouped in numerous ways. For example, three, four, five, or more (e.g., all) of the Zones A-I may be grouped. When grouped, the zones of individual and/or bonded playback devices may play back audio in synchrony with one another, as described in previously referenced U.S. Pat. No. 8,234,395. Playback devices may be dynamically grouped and ungrouped to form new or different groups that synchronously play back audio content.

[0098] In various implementations, the zones in an environment may be the default name of a zone within the group or a combination of the names of the zones within a zone group. For example, Zone Group **108b** can be assigned a name such as “Dining+Kitchen”, as shown in FIG. **1M**. In some embodiments, a zone group may be given a unique name selected by a user.

[0099] Certain data may be stored in a memory of a playback device (e.g., the memory **112b** of FIG. **1C**) as one or more state variables that are periodically updated and used to describe the state of a playback zone, the playback device(s), and/or a zone group associated therewith. The memory may also include the data associated with the state of the other devices of the media system and shared from time to time among the devices so that one or more of the devices have the most recent data associated with the system.

[0100] In some embodiments, the memory may store instances of various variable types associated with the states. Variables instances may be stored with identifiers (e.g., tags) corresponding to type. For example, certain identifiers may be a first type “a1” to identify playback device(s) of a zone, a second type “b1” to identify playback device(s) that may be bonded in the zone, and a third type “c1” to identify a zone group to which the zone may belong. As a related example, identifiers associated with the second bedroom **101c** may indicate that the playback device is the only playback device of the Zone C and not in a zone group. Identifiers associated with the Den may indicate that the Den is not grouped with other zones but includes bonded playback devices **110h-110k**. Identifiers associated with the Dining Room may indicate that the Dining Room is part of the Dining+Kitchen zone group **108b** and that devices **110b** and **110d** are grouped (FIG. **1L**). Identifiers associated with the Kitchen may indicate the same or similar information by virtue of the Kitchen being part of the Dining+Kitchen zone group **108b**. Other example zone variables and identifiers are described below.

[0101] In yet another example, the media playback system **100** may comprise variables or identifiers representing other associations of zones and zone groups, such as identifiers associated with Areas, as shown in FIG. **1M**. An area may involve a cluster of zone groups and/or zones not within a zone group. For instance, FIG. **1M** shows an Upper Area **109a** including Zones A-D, and a Lower Area **109b** including Zones E-I. In one aspect, an Area may be used to invoke a cluster of zone groups and/or zones that share one or more zones and/or zone groups of another cluster. In another aspect, this differs from a zone group, which does not share a zone with another zone group. Further examples of techniques for implementing Areas may be found, for example, in U.S. application Ser. No. 15/682,506 filed Aug. 21, 2017, and titled “Room Association Based on Name,” and U.S. Pat. No. 8,483,853 filed Sep. 11, 2007, and titled “Controlling and manipulating groupings in a multi-zone media system.” Each of these applications is incorporated herein by reference in its entirety. In some embodiments, the media playback system **100** may not implement Areas, in which case the system may not store variables associated with Areas.

III. Example Systems and Devices

[0102] FIG. **2A** is a front isometric view of a playback device **210** configured in accordance with aspects of the disclosed technology. FIG. **2B** is a front isometric view of the playback device **210** without a grille **216e**. FIG. **2C** is an exploded view of the playback device **210**. Referring to FIGS. **2A-2C** together, the playback device **210** comprises a housing **216** that includes an upper portion **216a**, a right or first side portion **216b**, a lower portion **216c**, a left or second side portion **216d**, the grille **216e**, and a rear portion **216f**. A plurality of fasteners **216g** (e.g., one or more screws, rivets, clips) attaches a frame **216h** to the housing **216**. A cavity **216j** (FIG. **2C**) in the housing **216** is

configured to receive the frame **216h** and electronics **212**. The frame **216h** is configured to carry a plurality of transducers **214** (identified individually in FIG. 2B as transducers **214a-f**). The electronics **212** (e.g., the electronics **112** of FIG. 1C) is configured to receive audio content from an audio source and send electrical signals corresponding to the audio content to the transducers **214** for playback.

[0103] The transducers **214** are configured to receive the electrical signals from the electronics **112**, and further configured to convert the received electrical signals into audible sound during playback. For instance, the transducers **214a-c** (e.g., tweeters) can be configured to output high frequency sound (e.g., sound waves having a frequency greater than about 2 kHz). The transducers **214d-f** (e.g., mid-woofers, woofers, midrange speakers) can be configured output sound at frequencies lower than the transducers **214a-c** (e.g., sound waves having a frequency lower than about 2 kHz). In some embodiments, the playback device **210** includes a number of transducers different than those illustrated in FIGS. 2A-2C. For example, as described in further detail below with respect to FIGS. 3A-3C, the playback device **210** can include fewer than six transducers (e.g., one, two, three). In other embodiments, however, the playback device **210** includes more than six transducers (e.g., nine, ten). Moreover, in some embodiments, all or a portion of the transducers **214** are configured to operate as a phased array to desirably adjust (e.g., narrow or widen) a radiation pattern of the transducers **214**, thereby altering a user's perception of the sound emitted from the playback device **210**.

[0104] In the illustrated embodiment of FIGS. 2A-2C, a filter **216i** is axially aligned with the transducer **214b**. The filter **216i** can be configured to desirably attenuate a predetermined range of frequencies that the transducer **214b** outputs to improve sound quality and a perceived sound stage output collectively by the transducers **214**. In some embodiments, however, the playback device **210** omits the filter **216i**. In other embodiments, the playback device **210** includes one or more additional filters aligned with the transducers **214b** and/or at least another of the transducers **214**.

[0105] FIGS. 3A and 3B are front and right isometric side views, respectively, of an NMD **320** configured in accordance with embodiments of the disclosed technology. FIG. 3C is an exploded view of the NMD **320**. FIG. 3D is an enlarged view of a portion of FIG. 3B including a user interface **313** of the NMD **320**. Referring first to FIGS. 3A-3C, the NMD **320** includes a housing **316** comprising an upper portion **316a**, a lower portion **316b** and an intermediate portion **316c** (e.g., a grille). A plurality of ports, holes, or apertures **316d** in the upper portion **316a** allow sound to pass through to one or more microphones **315** (FIG. 3C) positioned within the housing **316**. The one or more microphones **316** are configured to received sound via the apertures **316d** and produce electrical signals based on the received sound. In the illustrated embodiment, a frame **316e** (FIG. 3C) of the housing **316** surrounds cavities **316f** and **316g** configured to house, respectively, a first transducer **314a** (e.g., a tweeter) and a second transducer **314b** (e.g., a mid-woofer, a midrange speaker, a woofer). In other embodiments, however, the NMD **320** includes a single transducer, or more than two (e.g., two, five, six) transducers. In certain embodiments, the NMD **320** omits the transducers **314a** and **314b** altogether.

[0106] Electronics **312** (FIG. 3C) includes components configured to drive the transducers **314a** and **314b**, and further configured to analyze audio data corresponding to the electrical signals produced by the one or more microphones **315**. In some embodiments, for example, the electronics **312** comprises many or all of the components of the electronics **112** described above with respect to FIG. 1C. In certain embodiments, the electronics **312** includes components described above with respect to FIG. 1F such as, for example, the one or more processors **112a**, the memory **112b**, the software components **112c**, the network interface **112d**, etc. In some embodiments, the electronics **312** includes additional suitable components (e.g., proximity or other sensors).

[0107] Referring to FIG. 3D, the user interface **313** includes a plurality of control surfaces (e.g., buttons, knobs, capacitive surfaces) including a first control surface **313a** (e.g., a previous control), a second control surface **313b** (e.g., a next control), and a third control surface **313c** (e.g., a play

and/or pause control). A fourth control surface **313d** is configured to receive touch input corresponding to activation and deactivation of the one or more microphones **315**. A first indicator **313e** (e.g., one or more light emitting diodes (LEDs) or another suitable illuminator) can be configured to illuminate only when the one or more microphones **315** are activated. A second indicator **313f** (e.g., one or more LEDs) can be configured to remain solid during normal operation and to blink or otherwise change from solid to indicate a detection of voice activity. In some embodiments, the user interface **313** includes additional or fewer control surfaces and illuminators. In one embodiment, for example, the user interface **313** includes the first indicator **313e**, omitting the second indicator **313f**. Moreover, in certain embodiments, the NMD **320** comprises a playback device and a control device, and the user interface **313** comprises the user interface of the control device.

[0108] Referring to FIGS. 3A-3D together, the NMD **320** is configured to receive voice commands from one or more adjacent users via the one or more microphones **315**. As described above with respect to FIG. 1B, the one or more microphones **315** can acquire, capture, or record sound in a vicinity (e.g., a region within **10m** or less of the NMD **320**) and transmit electrical signals corresponding to the recorded sound to the electronics **312**. The electronics **312** can process the electrical signals and can analyze the resulting audio data to determine a presence of one or more voice commands (e.g., one or more activation words). In some embodiments, for example, after detection of one or more suitable voice commands, the NMD **320** is configured to transmit a portion of the recorded audio data to another device and/or a remote server (e.g., one or more of the computing devices **106** of FIG. 1B) for further analysis. The remote server can analyze the audio data, determine an appropriate action based on the voice command, and transmit a message to the NMD **320** to perform the appropriate action. For instance, a user may speak “Sonos, play Michael Jackson.” The NMD **320** can, via the one or more microphones **315**, record the user's voice utterance, determine the presence of a voice command, and transmit the audio data having the voice command to a remote server (e.g., one or more of the remote computing devices **106** of FIG. 1B, one or more servers of a VAS and/or another suitable service). The remote server can analyze the audio data and determine an action corresponding to the command. The remote server can then transmit a command to the NMD **320** to perform the determined action (e.g., play back audio content related to Michael Jackson). The NMD **320** can receive the command and play back the audio content related to Michael Jackson from a media content source. As described above with respect to FIG. 1B, suitable content sources can include a device or storage communicatively coupled to the NMD **320** via a LAN (e.g., the network **104** of FIG. 1B), a remote server (e.g., one or more of the remote computing devices **106** of FIG. 1B), etc. In certain embodiments, however, the NMD **320** determines and/or performs one or more actions corresponding to the one or more voice commands without intervention or involvement of an external device, computer, or server.

[0109] FIG. 3E is a functional block diagram showing additional features of the NMD **320** in accordance with aspects of the disclosure. The NMD **320** includes components configured to facilitate voice command capture including voice activity detector component(s) **312k**, beam former components **312l**, acoustic echo cancellation (AEC) and/or self-sound suppression components **312m**, activation word detector components **312n**, and voice/speech conversion components **312o** (e.g., voice-to-text and text-to-voice). In the illustrated embodiment of FIG. 3E, the foregoing components **312k-312o** are shown as separate components. In some embodiments, however, one or more of the components **312k-312o** are subcomponents of the processors **112a**.

[0110] The beamforming and self-sound suppression components **312l** and **312m** are configured to detect an audio signal and determine aspects of voice input represented in the detected audio signal, such as the direction, amplitude, frequency spectrum, etc. The voice activity detector activity components **312k** are operably coupled with the beamforming and AEC components **312l** and **312m** and are configured to determine a direction and/or directions from which voice activity is likely to have occurred in the detected audio signal. Potential speech directions can be identified by

monitoring metrics which distinguish speech from other sounds. Such metrics can include, for example, energy within the speech band relative to background noise and entropy within the speech band, which is measure of spectral structure. As those of ordinary skill in the art will appreciate, speech typically has a lower entropy than most common background noise.

[0111] The activation word detector components **312n** are configured to monitor and analyze received audio to determine if any activation words (e.g., wake words) are present in the received audio. The activation word detector components **312n** may analyze the received audio using an activation word detection algorithm. If the activation word detector **312n** detects an activation word, the NMD **320** may process voice input contained in the received audio. Example activation word detection algorithms accept audio as input and provide an indication of whether an activation word is present in the audio. Many first-and third-party activation word detection algorithms are known and commercially available. For instance, operators of a voice service may make their algorithm available for use in third-party devices. Alternatively, an algorithm may be trained to detect certain activation words. In some embodiments, the activation word detector **312n** runs multiple activation word detection algorithms on the received audio simultaneously (or substantially simultaneously). As noted above, different voice services (e.g. AMAZON's ALEXA®, APPLE's SIRI®, or MICROSOFT's CORTANA®) can each use a different activation word for invoking their respective voice service. To support multiple services, the activation word detector **312n** may run the received audio through the activation word detection algorithm for each supported voice service in parallel.

[0112] The speech/text conversion components **312o** may facilitate processing by converting speech in the voice input to text. In some embodiments, the electronics **312** can include voice recognition software that is trained to a particular user or a particular set of users associated with a household. Such voice recognition software may implement voice-processing algorithms that are tuned to specific voice profile(s). Tuning to specific voice profiles may require less computationally intensive algorithms than traditional voice activity services, which typically sample from a broad base of users and diverse requests that are not targeted to media playback systems.

[0113] FIG. 3F is a schematic diagram of an example voice input **328** captured by the NMD **320** in accordance with aspects of the disclosure. The voice input **328** can include an activation word portion **328a** and a voice utterance portion **328b**. In some embodiments, the activation word **557a** can be a known activation word, such as “Alexa,” which is associated with AMAZON's ALEXA®. In other embodiments, however, the voice input **328** may not include an activation word. In some embodiments, a network microphone device may output an audible and/or visible response upon detection of the activation word portion **328a**. In addition or alternately, an NMB may output an audible and/or visible response after processing a voice input and/or a series of voice inputs.

[0114] The voice utterance portion **328b** may include, for example, one or more spoken commands (identified individually as a first command **328c** and a second command **328e**) and one or more spoken keywords (identified individually as a first keyword **328d** and a second keyword **328f**). In one example, the first command **328c** can be a command to play music, such as a specific song, album, playlist, etc. In this example, the keywords may be one or words identifying one or more zones in which the music is to be played, such as the Living Room and the Dining Room shown in FIG. 1A. In some examples, the voice utterance portion **328b** can include other information, such as detected pauses (e.g., periods of non-speech) between words spoken by a user, as shown in FIG. 3F. The pauses may demarcate the locations of separate commands, keywords, or other information spoke by the user within the voice utterance portion **328b**.

[0115] In some embodiments, the media playback system **100** is configured to temporarily reduce the volume of audio content that it is playing while detecting the activation word portion **557a**. The media playback system **100** may restore the volume after processing the voice input **328**, as shown in FIG. 3F. Such a process can be referred to as ducking, examples of which are disclosed in U.S.

patent application Ser. No. 15/438,749, incorporated by reference herein in its entirety.

[0116] FIGS. 4A-4D are schematic diagrams of a control device **430** (e.g., the control device **130a** of FIG. 1H, a smartphone, a tablet, a dedicated control device, an IoT device, and/or another suitable device) showing corresponding user interface displays in various states of operation. The control device comprises one or more processors, memory, software components, a network interface (also referred to herein as a “communication interface”).

[0117] A first user interface display **431a** (FIG. 4A) includes a display name **433a** (i.e., “Rooms”). A selected group region **433b** displays audio content information (e.g., artist name, track name, album art) of audio content played back in the selected group and/or zone. Group regions **433c** and **433d** display corresponding group and/or zone name, and audio content information audio content played back or next in a playback queue of the respective group or zone. An audio content region **433e** includes information related to audio content in the selected group and/or zone (i.e., the group and/or zone indicated in the selected group region **433b**). A lower display region **433f** is configured to receive touch input to display one or more other user interface displays. For example, if a user selects “Browse” in the lower display region **433f**, the control device **430** can be configured to output a second user interface display **431b** (FIG. 4B) comprising a plurality of music services **433g** (e.g., Spotify, Radio by Tunein, Apple Music, Pandora, Amazon, TV, local music, line-in) through which the user can browse and from which the user can select media content for play back via one or more playback devices (e.g., one of the playback devices **110** of FIG. 1A). Alternatively, if the user selects “My Sonos” in the lower display region **433f**, the control device **430** can be configured to output a third user interface display **431c** (FIG. 4C). A first media content region **433h** can include graphical representations (e.g., album art) corresponding to individual albums, stations, or playlists. A second media content region **433i** can include graphical representations (e.g., album art) corresponding to individual songs, tracks, or other media content. If the user selects a graphical representation **433j** (FIG. 4C), the control device **430** can be configured to begin play back of audio content corresponding to the graphical representation **433j** and output a fourth user interface display **431d** fourth user interface display **431d** includes an enlarged version of the graphical representation **433j**, media content information **433k** (e.g., track name, artist, album), transport controls **433m** (e.g., play, previous, next, pause, volume), and indication **433n** of the currently selected group and/or zone name.

[0118] FIG. 5 is a schematic diagram of a control device **530** (e.g., a laptop computer, a desktop computer). The control device **530** includes transducers **534**, a microphone **535**, and a camera **536**. A user interface **531** includes a transport control region **533a**, a playback status region **533b**, a playback zone region **533c**, a playback queue region **533d**, and a media content source region **533e**. The transport control region comprises one or more controls for controlling media playback including, for example, volume, previous, play/pause, next, repeat, shuffle, track position, crossfade, equalization, etc. The audio content source region **533e** includes a listing of one or more media content sources from which a user can select media items for play back and/or adding to a playback queue.

[0119] The playback zone region **533b** can include representations of playback zones within the media playback system **100** (FIGS. 1A and 1B). In some embodiments, the graphical representations of playback zones may be selectable to bring up additional selectable icons to manage or configure the playback zones in the media playback system, such as a creation of bonded zones, creation of zone groups, separation of zone groups, renaming of zone groups, etc. In the illustrated embodiment, a “group” icon is provided within each of the graphical representations of playback zones. The “group” icon provided within a graphical representation of a particular zone may be selectable to bring up options to select one or more other zones in the media playback system to be grouped with the particular zone. Once grouped, playback devices in the zones that have been grouped with the particular zone can be configured to play audio content in synchrony with the playback device(s) in the particular zone. Analogously, a “group” icon may be provided

within a graphical representation of a zone group. In the illustrated embodiment, the “group” icon may be selectable to bring up options to deselect one or more zones in the zone group to be removed from the zone group. In some embodiments, the control device **530** includes other interactions and implementations for grouping and ungrouping zones via the user interface **531**. In certain embodiments, the representations of playback zones in the playback zone region **533b** can be dynamically updated as playback zone or zone group configurations are modified.

[0120] The playback status region **533c** includes graphical representations of audio content that is presently being played, previously played, or scheduled to play next in the selected playback zone or zone group. The selected playback zone or zone group may be visually distinguished on the user interface, such as within the playback zone region **533b** and/or the playback queue region **533d**. The graphical representations may include track title, artist name, album name, album year, track length, and other relevant information that may be useful for the user to know when controlling the media playback system **100** via the user interface **531**.

[0121] The playback queue region **533d** includes graphical representations of audio content in a playback queue associated with the selected playback zone or zone group. In some embodiments, each playback zone or zone group may be associated with a playback queue containing information corresponding to zero or more audio items for playback by the playback zone or zone group. For instance, each audio item in the playback queue may comprise a uniform resource identifier (URI), a uniform resource locator (URL) or some other identifier that may be used by a playback device in the playback zone or zone group to find and/or retrieve the audio item from a local audio content source or a networked audio content source, possibly for playback by the playback device. In some embodiments, for example, a playlist can be added to a playback queue, in which information corresponding to each audio item in the playlist may be added to the playback queue. In some embodiments, audio items in a playback queue may be saved as a playlist. In certain embodiments, a playback queue may be empty, or populated but “not in use” when the playback zone or zone group is playing continuously streaming audio content, such as Internet radio that may continue to play until otherwise stopped, rather than discrete audio items that have playback durations. In some embodiments, a playback queue can include Internet radio and/or other streaming audio content items and be “in use” when the playback zone or zone group is playing those items.

[0122] When playback zones or zone groups are “grouped” or “ungrouped,” playback queues associated with the affected playback zones or zone groups may be cleared or re-associated. For example, if a first playback zone including a first playback queue is grouped with a second playback zone including a second playback queue, the established zone group may have an associated playback queue that is initially empty, that contains audio items from the first playback queue (such as if the second playback zone was added to the first playback zone), that contains audio items from the second playback queue (such as if the first playback zone was added to the second playback zone), or a combination of audio items from both the first and second playback queues. Subsequently, if the established zone group is ungrouped, the resulting first playback zone may be re-associated with the previous first playback queue or be associated with a new playback queue that is empty or contains audio items from the playback queue associated with the established zone group before the established zone group was ungrouped. Similarly, the resulting second playback zone may be re-associated with the previous second playback queue, or be associated with a new playback queue that is empty, or contains audio items from the playback queue associated with the established zone group before the established zone group was ungrouped.

[0123] FIG. **6** is a message flow diagram illustrating data exchanges between devices of the media playback system **100** (FIGS. **1A-1M**).

[0124] At step **650a**, the media playback system **100** receives an indication of selected media content (e.g., one or more songs, albums, playlists, podcasts, videos, stations) via the control device **130a**. The selected media content can comprise, for example, media items stored locally on or more devices (e.g., the audio source **105** of FIG. **1C**) connected to the media playback system and/or

media items stored on one or more media service servers (one or more of the remote computing devices **106** of FIG. **1B**). In response to receiving the indication of the selected media content, the control device **130a** transmits a message **651a** to the playback device **110a** (FIGS. **1A-1C**) to add the selected media content to a playback queue on the playback device **110a**.

[0125] At step **650b**, the playback device **110a** receives the message **651a** and adds the selected media content to the playback queue for play back.

[0126] At step **650c**, the control device **130a** receives input corresponding to a command to play back the selected media content. In response to receiving the input corresponding to the command to play back the selected media content, the control device **130a** transmits a message **651b** to the playback device **110a** causing the playback device **110a** to play back the selected media content. In response to receiving the message **651b**, the playback device **110a** transmits a message **651c** to the computing device **106a** requesting the selected media content. The computing device **106a**, in response to receiving the message **651c**, transmits a message **651d** comprising data (e.g., audio data, video data, a URL, a URI) corresponding to the requested media content.

[0127] At step **650d**, the playback device **110a** receives the message **651d** with the data corresponding to the requested media content and plays back the associated media content.

[0128] At step **650e**, the playback device **110a** optionally causes one or more other devices to play back the selected media content. In one example, the playback device **110a** is one of a bonded zone of two or more players (FIG. **1M**). The playback device **110a** can receive the selected media content and transmit all or a portion of the media content to other devices in the bonded zone. In another example, the playback device **110a** is a coordinator of a group and is configured to transmit and receive timing information from one or more other devices in the group. The other one or more devices in the group can receive the selected media content from the computing device **106a** and begin playback of the selected media content in response to a message from the playback device **110a** such that all of the devices in the group play back the selected media content in synchrony.

IV. Methods and Systems for Implementing Routines and Operating Modes at Playback Devices

[0129] In some embodiments, routines (also referred to as “scenes”) can be used to customize and/or modify the behavior of playback devices **110**. A user can select or create a set of routines, or scenes, that cause a playback device **110a** to play back media content in a user-defined manner. For example, the user may select a routine that causes the playback device **110a** to play back the sound of ocean waves. Further, the user may indicate a particular user-defined acoustic parameter in which the ocean waves should be played back, such as by selecting a particular user-defined volume. Further, in some embodiments, a routine can continue execution through the play back of media content. For instance, a routine may be configured to ramp up the volume associated with media content over a five-minute period. Similarly, a routine may be configured to dynamically raise the volume associated with media content in response to ambient noise around one or more playback devices **110**.

[0130] Additionally, sets of routines may be utilized to customize and/or modify the behavior of playback devices **110**. For example, a particular ordered set of routines may be associated with a particular playback device **110** such that the routines are executed in sequential order. For instance, each routine within the particular ordered set of routines may be associated with different media content (e.g., song, tracks, radio station, playlist, podcast, audiobook). As the playback device finishes one of the current routine, the next routine may execute and cause the playback device **110a** to play the media content associated with the next routine. Alternatively or additionally, a user may also cause the playback device **110a** to advance to the next routine by initiating a trigger condition, such as by selecting a button.

[0131] In some embodiments, a set of routines are used to define, at least in part, a playback mode. As described herein, a playback mode comprises one or more routines that define a particular set of behaviors associated with a playback device **110a** that is operating in the playback mode. Further, in some embodiments, the one or more routines configure the user interface **113** of the playback

device **110a** to activate or modify different aspects of the one or more routines. For example, the one or more routines may configure a portion of the user interface **113** that is used to advance between songs to instead advance between the one or more routines. As such, when touching the “skip button” the one or more routines may cause the playback device **110a** to advance to the next routine within the one or more routines.

[0132] In some embodiments, the playback device **110a** is configured to execute transport commands (e.g., play, previous, next, pause, volume) differently in different modes. The transport commands may be initiated on a user interface **313** associated with a playback device **110a** or at a user interface **133** associated with a control device **130**. For example when operating in a daytime playback mode (also referred to herein as a “default playback mode”), pressing a skip button, or otherwise issuing a “skip” command, causes the playback device **110a** to move between individual tracks in the playback queue. In contrast, in a routine-based playback mode (e.g., a sleep playback mode), pressing the skip button, or otherwise issuing a “skip” command, causes the playback device **110a** to move between routines within a set of one or more routines. Similarly, in a daytime playback mode (or default playback mode), pressing a “play” button, or otherwise issuing a play command, causes the playback device **110a** to start playing a track within a playback queue. In contrast, in a routine-based playback mode (e.g., a sleep playback mode), pressing the play button, or otherwise issuing a “play” command, causes the playback device **110a** to start a routine within a set of one or more routines.

[0133] In some embodiments, individual playback modes can customize the actions associated with different transport commands (e.g., play, previous, next, pause, volume). The customizations may be defined by one or more routines that are associated with the individual playback modes. For instance, a particular playback mode may cause the skip command to speed up an aspect of a routine. For example, pressing the skip command may cause media content to play at a faster speed. As an additional example, a particular playback mode may cause the stop command to emit an alarm sound. For example, a particular playback mode may be associated with a game and pushing a stop button on a playback device may cause an alarm to sound as part of the game. One will appreciate that different playback modes may cause any number of different actions to be associated with the transport commands. Further, one will appreciate that different playback modes may customize the actions caused by interactions with the user interfaces **313** (such as buttons, knobs, capacitive surfaces, etc.) on playback devices. Accordingly, buttons that have specific functions (e.g., play, stop, skip, pause, volume, etc.) within a default playback mode can be repurposed to perform custom actions as directed by the particular playback mode.

[0134] In some embodiments, multiple different playback modes may be available for a user to choose between. For example, the multiple different playback modes may comprise a sleep mode, a business playback mode, a fitness playback mode, a cooking playback mode, a cleaning playback mode, or a holiday playback mode. As a further example, the fitness playback mode may comprise routines that are created to complement a high-intensity interval training workout. For instance, the routines may cause upbeat music to play until a user presses a button on one or more playback devices **110**. In response to the user pressing the button, a cooldown timer may initiate and audibly count down for a user-specified amount time. The timer arriving at zero may comprise a trigger condition that causes the next routine to begin playing the upbeat music. As such, a user can work out to their desired music, press a button to enter a timed cooldown period, and then begin to work out again when the music automatically begins playing. In view of this disclosure, one will appreciate that a user may be able to edit playback modes or create custom playback modes that are associated with pre-made and/or custom routines.

[0135] FIG. 7 is a schematic of a timeline **700** associated with one or more playback devices **110** that are shown as operating within two different playback modes **710**. Specifically, the timeline **700** shows that the associated playback devices **110** operating within a daytime playback mode **710a** and a sleep playback mode **710b**. In some embodiments, the daytime playback mode **710a** is

considered a default mode of the one or more playback devices **110**. For example, in the “default mode” a button normally associated with “play” will cause media content to be played. In contrast, when operating within a playback mode, the play button may be repurposed to perform another function—such as skipping to the next routine, which may not be media content. In some embodiments, the daytime playback mode **710a** is not associated with any routines or scenes. [0136] As described above, the daytime playback mode **710a** may be considered a default playback mode such that any time period that is not associated with a particular playback mode is automatically associated with the default playback mode (also referred to as the daytime playback mode **710a**). For example, one or more playback devices **110** may be associated with a wake-up playback mode from 6 AM until 8 AM and then again with a sleep playback mode **710b** from 10 PM until 6 AM. In such a configuration, the time period from 8 AM until 10 PM may automatically be associated with the daytime playback mode **710a**.

[0137] One will appreciate the depicted timeline **700** is only exemplary of many different possible configurations of playback modes **710**. In the depicted embodiment, the timeline **700** depicts the daytime playback mode **710a** as extending from 6 AM until 10 PM. During the daytime playback mode **710a** the user's alarm sounds between 6 AM and 7 PM. The user silences that alarm before completely waking up. Once awake, the user starts to listen to the morning news on one or more playback devices **110**. The user may initiate the morning news through any number of different means such as, but not limited to: a vocal command to “play news,” a physical user interface integrated into the one or more playback devices **110**, a command entered into a control device (such as a mobile phone), a routine that automatically causes the morning news to play at a particular time of day, or any number of ways described herein.

[0138] At some point after listening to the news, the user silences the one or more playback devices **110**. After 6 PM, the user starts to listen to workout music. As described above with respect to the morning news, there are a number of different ways that the user can start her workout music. After working out, the user may switch to her cooking music while she prepares her evening meal. Once she has finished eating, the user may cause the one or more playback devices **110** to play a local radio station while she cleans up.

[0139] At 10 PM, the one or more playback devices **110** receive a playback mode indication. As used herein, a playback mode indication comprises a command that causes the one or more playback devices **110** to enter into a playback mode **710**. The playback mode indication may be received from a user, a remote server, a control device, the one or more playback devices, or be generated by a trigger condition. For example, the playback mode indication depicted with respect to the timeline **700** comprises a trigger condition in the form of a time-based trigger that causes the one or more playback devices **110** to enter the sleep playback mode **710b** at 10 PM. In some embodiments, one or more of the playback devices **110**, a control device, or a remote server may be configured to determine that a trigger condition has occurred. For example, trigger conditions may comprise a particular time, a geolocation of a user, a button press, a vocal command, a signal from an IoT device, a signal from a cloud service, or any other detectable condition or signal.

[0140] After receiving the playback mode indication, the one or more playback devices **110** operate within the indicated playback mode **710**—in this example the sleep playback mode **710b**. After initiating operation of the sleep playback mode **710b**, the one or more playback devices **110** access a particular set of routines that is associated with the sleep playback mode **710b**. In various different embodiments, the one or more playback devices **110** access the particular set of routines from local memory, from a local network device, from a control device, or from a cloud network **102**.

[0141] The sleep playback mode **710b** depicted in FIG. 7 is associated with one or more routines that cause the one or more playback devices to play back media content with a user-defined acoustic parameter. Specifically, the sleep playback mode **710b** is associated with a sleep quickstart 1 routine **720a** and a sleep quickstart 2 routine **720b**. As used herein a “quickstart routine” or

“quickstart” is a type of routine that is set to trigger by some action, such as a button press or control API command. A quickstart routine provides easy, fast access to specific media content. In some embodiments, there may be a limited number of quickstart routines that can be set. Additionally, a user-defined acoustic parameter may comprise a volume level, a mix level, a balance level, or a media content-specific variable. A media content-specific variable allows a user to specify acoustic attributes that are unique to the particular media content. For example, the particular media content may comprise one or more component tracks within the media content that can be independently adjusted (e.g., track speed, track sound, track channel, track balance, and other related attributes). For example, one track may comprise the sound of ocean waves. As such, a user can increase the rhythm of the waves, while the other tracks (e.g., the sound of seagulls and wind) continue to play at the original speed. The one or more routines also comprise one or more user interface interactions that are configured to cause the one or more playback devices **110** to advance between the one or more routines within the particular set of routines.

[0142] In some embodiments, as soon the particular playback mode is initiated, the one or more playback devices **110** will automatically begin to execute the first routine in the particular set of routines. In contrast, in some embodiments, the one or more playback devices **110** will continue to play back the media content that the one or more playback devices **110** were playing prior to the start of the particular playback mode. For example, as depicted in FIG. 7, the local radio station continues to play past the start of the sleep playback mode **710b** until the user taps pause on a user interface **113** associated with the one or more playback devices **110**. Once the user taps “play” the first routine of the sleep playback mode is executed.

[0143] FIGS. 8A and 8B are schematic diagrams of a user interface **313** (also referred to as user interface **113**) of a playback device **110a** configured to receive one or more user interface interactions. In some embodiments, the user interface **313** comprises one or more buttons integrated into a control surface of the playback device **110**. One will appreciate, however, that in additional or alternative embodiments the user interface may comprise a voice user interface (e.g., a VAS), physical knobs, a camera, touch screen or surface, or any other means for input. As depicted in FIG. 8A, pressing the play button **800** causes the one or more playback devices **110** to execute at least one routine from the set of routines. For example, once the user taps a “play” button, sleep quickstart **1** routine **720a** is executed when the playback device **110a** is in sleep mode. In this example, sleep quickstart **1** routine **720a** may comprise soothing ocean sounds that help the user fall asleep.

[0144] User interface elements **810a**, **810b** depict exemplary visual elements that may be presented on a control device **130** when the one or more playback devices **110** are operating in sleep playback mode. These visual elements may be displayed on a screen on or associated with the playback device **110** or on a controller of the playback device **110**. As depicted, pressing the play button within user interface element **810a** causes the playback device **110** to play ocean sounds. When the user activates a skip or next function, the control device **130** causes the one or more playback devices **110** to advance to the sleep quickstart **2** routine **720b**, which in turn causes the one or more playback devices **110** to play white noise.

[0145] FIG. 8B depicts the user interface with an ordered set of routines **820(a-f)**. In this depicted example, after receiving an indication of a user interface interaction **830**, such as a swipe across, or a selection of, at least one of the one or more buttons, the playback device **110** advances to a particular routine of the one or more routines. In particular, in the depicted example, each time a user swipes the buttons the one or more playback devices **110** advance to the next routine within the ordered set of routines **820(a-f)**. As such, in some embodiments, the one or more routines associated with a particular playback mode are ordered within a set, such that the routines are executed in a particular order. One will appreciate that the one or more routines may define any number of different user interface interactions that can be used to execute, stop, pause, advance, or otherwise interact with the routines. Further, the ordered set of routines **820(a-f)** may comprise any

number of different types of media content or types of actions performed by the one or more playback devices **110**. For instance, one or more routines may comprise a dynamic weather report, a game (e.g., a quiz), an interaction with an IoT device (e.g., dimming a light), or any number of other programmable actions.

[0146] FIGS. **9A-15B** depict various different embodiments of playback mode interfaces. In some embodiments, the playback mode interfaces comprise configuration interfaces that are used to configure and/or launch different playback modes or routines. In some embodiments, the playback mode interfaces comprise dashboard interfaces that are used to show a status of playback devices **110** within a household. The playback mode interfaces depicted herein are provided for sake of example and explanation, and do not limit potential additional or alternative embodiments of interfaces to any particular form or device. Turning now to specific interfaces, FIGS. **9A** and **9B** are schematic diagrams of related playback mode interfaces **900a**, **900b** (also referred to herein interchangeably as “configuration interfaces” or “dashboard interfaces”). The playback mode interfaces **900a**, **900b** may be displayed on a control device **130** for use in creating or modify routines and playback modes or a dashboard device for use in viewing and monitoring the status of playback devices **110** within a household. The depicted playback mode interfaces **900a** and **900b** are exemplary and can be presented on any device with a viewable display (e.g., control device **530**). Additionally, the visual aspects of the playback mode interfaces **900a** and **900b** are also exemplary and in some embodiments routines can be modified and/or created using voice commands without the presence of a viewable display. As such, the playback mode interfaces may comprise at least one microphone configured to receive voice commands or a user interface configured to receive physical inputs from a user.

[0147] The control device **130** can receive, via a playback mode interface **900a** and **900b**, one or more first user inputs associating a particular routine (also referred to as a particular “scene”) with a particular playback mode and associating the particular playback mode with one or more playback devices. For example, configuration interface **900a** depicts multiple playback device icons **910(a-e)** that each represent a different playback device **110** (in e.g., speakers) within a particular media playback system **100**. The depicted playback device icons **910(a-e)** are each associated with a playback device name **912**, a playback device mode **914**, and a playback device mode status **916**. Playback mode interface **900b** depicts two different rendered views **940a**, **940b** within the playback mode interface **900b**. Rendered view **940a** displays to a user various sleep quickstarts **950a**, **950b**. If a user selects the “Sleep Quickstarts” option **960**, the playback mode interface **900b** displays the second rendered view **940b**. Within the second rendered view **940b**, a user it able to further customize the sleep quickstarts **950a**, **950b** by selecting the quickstarts individually. A user may also be able to launch a sleep quickstart **950a**, **950b** from either playback mode interfaces **900a** or playback mode interface **900b**. One will appreciate, however, that additional or alternative embodiments may display different information associated with each playback device **110**.

[0148] The playback mode interface **900a** also depicts various user-defined acoustic parameters that can be associated with media content. Similar options may also be available to the user through playback mode interface **900b**. For example, a first routine **922** is associated with instructions that cause a playback setting of one or more playback devices **110** to be associated with particular media content, in this case media content, or nature sounds, referred to as “Seattle Rainfall.” The user-defined acoustic parameters include a user defined volume of “25” and a media content-specific settings relating to the rain speed, in this case “medium.” Additionally, in some embodiments, the user-defined acoustic parameters also include the individual playback devices **110** that are associated with the first routine **922**. For example, in the depicted embodiment, the user has turned on the playback devices mode status **916** of the playback devices **110** associated with playback device icons **910a**, **910b**, and **910c**. As such, the first routine **922** is configured to cause the audio content “Seattle Rainfall” to play on the selected playback devices **110**.

[0149] The playback mode interface **900a**, **900b** also provides the user with the ability to associate a particular trigger condition with a particular routine. For example, in FIG. **9A** the user indicated set a trigger condition field **930** for the playback devices **110** to enter sleep mode at 9:30 PM. Additionally, the user sets a conditional trigger for the playback devices **110** to exit sleep mode at 6:30 AM. The trigger conditions define conditions that causes the particular routine to be executed or exited. Accordingly, at 9:30 PM a sleep playback mode would be executed at the “Master Bedroom-Mary” playback device, “Master Bedroom-Josh,” playback device, and the “Master Bathroom” playback device. At 6:30 AM the playback devices **110** would exit the sleep playback mode.

[0150] Many different options may be provided to a user relating to trigger conditions. For example, trigger conditions may comprise a particular time, a geolocation of a user, a button press, a vocal command, a signal from an IoT device, a signal from a cloud network **102**, or any other detectable condition or signal. In some embodiments, a trigger condition is identified at a server that is remote to the playback device **420** (e.g., computing device **106**), at the one or more playback devices **110**, or at a control device **130**. In some embodiments, a user is able to select and revise one or more trigger conditions associated with a playback mode or routine. Alternatively, in some embodiments trigger conditions are built into particular playback modes or routines and are not user adjustable.

[0151] For example, a user may desire for one or more playback devices to enter a welcome home playback mode whenever the user's geolocation is detected as returning to her home. The user may have a mobile phone that is associated with a user account stored in the cloud network **102**. The user's mobile phone may communicate with the cloud network **102** to indicate the user's current geolocation. When the cloud network **102** detects that the user, who was previously not at home, is not traveling home, the cloud network **102** communicates an instruction that causes the one or more playback devices to enter the welcome home playback mode. The instruction communicated by the cloud network **102** may comprise a current geolocation of the user or may comprise a command to enter the welcome home playback mode.

[0152] As such, in some embodiments, the media playback system **100** may process the geolocation information locally and determine whether to enter the welcome home playback mode, or the cloud network **102** may process the geolocation information and directly issue a command that causes the media playback system **100** to enter the welcome home playback mode. Similarly, other trigger conditions can be processed locally within the media playback system **100**, remotely in the cloud network **102**, or in some combination of the two. In some embodiments, once the user creates or modifies a routine or playback mode in the playback mode interface **900a**, **900b**, the control device **130** transmits, via a communication interface, the particular routine to a server (e.g., computing device **106**) remote from the control device **130**.

[0153] Additionally, in some embodiments, the trigger condition field **930** may provide for options for third-party services or third-party devices to provide a trigger condition. For instance, a third-party robotic vacuum may be configured to send an indication of a trigger condition whenever the robotic vacuum begins vacuuming. In response to receiving the indication of the trigger condition, a routine may cause the one or more playback devices **110** to increase their volume to a specified level in order to drown out the sounds of the robotic vacuum. Further discussion of the process for receiving indications of trigger conditions from third parties is provided with respect to FIGS. **16-18**.

[0154] Additionally, in some embodiments, the control device **130** can receive through the playback mode interface **900a**, **900b** user input associating a particular routine (e.g., routine **922**) with multiple playback devices (e.g., playback device icons **910(a-c)** each represent a different playback device **110**). The routines may configure the playback devices **110** associated with the playback device icons **910(a-c)** to play one or more media content files-in the depicted case, “Seattle Rainfall” and “White Noise.” Additionally, one or more media content settings may

configure the multiple playback devices to play the one or more media content with a user-defined acoustic parameter. For example, in accordance with routine **922a**, the playback devices are configured to play back “Seattle Rainfall” with a rain speed of “medium.”

[0155] Further, in some embodiments, the one or more playback devices **110** may be “bonded” or “merged” to form specified groups, or zones, as described with respect to FIGS. **1L** through **1M**. As described above, bonded playback devices may have different playback responsibilities (e.g., channel responsibilities). Further, with respect to the configuration interfaces **900(a-e)**, a bonded or merged pair of playback devices or a zone of playback devices may be represented by a single UI entity (i.e., a playback device icon **910**). Accordingly, after receiving a playback mode indication, the control device **130** can cause one or more playback devices within a predefined group, or zone, to operate within the particular playback mode. In some embodiments, the particular playback mode may be selected from a set of multiple playback modes.

[0156] In some embodiments, the one or more playback devices **110** may be assigned different playback roles in a group such as background, foreground, or ambient. For example, a group of multiple playback devices **110** may be configured to play beach sounds. A routine associated with the beach sounds may further configure a first subset of the group of multiple playback devices **110** to play wave sounds and a second subset of the group of multiple playback devices **110** to play the sounds of birds and wind. In some embodiments, a playback mode interface **900a**, **900b** may provide a user with the ability to configure the associated routine such that the playback devices within the different subsets are selected by the user. For instance, the user may select playback devices at the front of a room to play the wave sounds and playback devices at the back of the room to play the bird and wind sounds. The user may also be able to customize volume levels, speed levels, and other user-defined acoustic parameters on a subset-level basis. For example, the user may configure the speed of the waves to ramp up over time and the speed of the birds and the wind to ramp down over time.

[0157] Accordingly, one or more media content settings associated with routines or scenes may configure at least one playback device selected from a group of multiple playback devices to play the media content in a different manner than at least one other playback device selected from the multiple playback devices. For example, one of the playback devices may play a different audio channel than the other playback devices. In some embodiments, a user may be able to further specify different playback devices behaviors. For example, a user may specify that a particular playback device play back media content at a louder volume than the other playback devices associated with a particular routine. Additionally, a user may specify that a particular playback device go to sleep at a different time than the other playback devices associated with a particular routine. For instance, a user may desire that a playback device immediately adjacent her bed sleep after an hour, while other playback devices associated with the same routine or scene continue to playback the media content.

[0158] In some embodiments, the playback mode interface **900a**, **900b** may provide a user with an option to set group or room specific trigger conditions. For example, a user may have one or more speakers within the room of a young child. The user may desire that the child be able to turn the music off but not that the child be able to advance through the routines. Accordingly, the playback mode interface **900a**, **900b** may allow a user to set particular user interface inputs as trigger conditions on some playback devices **110**, while turning those trigger conditions off or setting different trigger conditions for other playback devices **110**.

[0159] Returning to the playback mode interfaces **900a,b** of FIGS. **9A** and **9B**, the different exemplary configuration interfaces **900a**, **900b** depict various examples of playback modes and routines being associated with one or more playback devices **110**. The functionality and description associated with the playback mode interfaces **900a** and **900b** can also be extended to the playback mode interfaces disclosed and described in FIGS. **10A-15B**. The depicted playback mode interfaces **900a**, **900b** are configured to allow a user to create a playback modes (e.g., a sleep playback mode)

by adjusting various trigger conditions, routines, and user-defined acoustic parameters. Once a playback mode is started, the one or more playback devices **110** will react to the defined trigger conditions and respond to the defined routines.

[0160] The playback mode interfaces **1000a**, **1000b** of FIGS. **10A** and **10B** provides a user with greater flexibility in associating quickstart routines with the sleep playback mode. For example, the user has defined quickstart **1** routine **922a**, quickstart **2** routine **922b**, quickstart **3** routine **922c**, quickstart **4** routine **922d**, quickstart **5** routine **922e**, and quickstart **6** routine **922f** in relation to the sleep playback mode. In the depicted embodiment, each quickstart is associated with different media content and different user-defined acoustic parameters (e.g., volume, “rain speed,” “conversation,” “music,” “wind speed,” and “bird volume.”) Further, a user is able to indicate which playback devices **110** should be associated with the one or more quick start routines **922(a-f)** by selecting the appropriate playback device icons **910(a-e)**. Additionally, the playback mode interfaces **1000a**, **1000b** allows a user to arrange the quickstart routines **922(a-c)** into a desired sequential order.

[0161] The playback mode interfaces **1100a** and **1100b** of FIGS. **11A** and **11B** allows a user to set a trigger condition field **930** for the sleep playback mode. The user is also able to indicate which playback devices should be associated with the sleep playback mode by selecting the appropriate playback device icons **910(a-e)**. In this embodiment, the user is also able to associate quickstart routines **922(a-d)** with specific playback devices **110**. For example, as shown on rendered view **1110c** of playback mode interface **1100b**, a user is able to individually activate different playback devices **110** with a toggle switch and to associate specific quickstart routines **922(a-d)** with individual playback devices **110**. As depicted, in some embodiments, an inactive quickstart routine **922d** may be associated with a toggle switch set to off (as shown in playback mode interface **1100a**) or may appear grayed-out (as shown in playback mode interface **1100c**). One will appreciate, however, that a number of different user interface elements may be utilized to control and configure the respective playback devices and quickstart routines **922(a-d)**. For example, a user may be able to associate a particular quickstart routine with playback device by dragging the quickstart routine **922a** to an area of the screen associated with a particular playback devices **110a** (e.g., the Bedroom-Mary playback device). Further, the user is able to set playback device-specific variables such as a “sleep timer” and whether “adaptive volume” should be active.

[0162] Using these playback mode interfaces **1100a** and **1100b** a user is able to customize how different subsets of playback devices **110** will behave. For instance, a married couple may each have a speaker on their own side of their shared bedroom. Using the playback mode interfaces **1100a** and **1100b**, each partner may be able to customize how their respective playback device **110** operates within the sleep mode. This allows one or more users the ability to individually control playback devices with respect to the one or more routines **922(a-d)**. For instance, one partner may wish to have a speaker that is next to their bed sleep sooner than the other partner's speaker that is across the room. As such playback mode interfaces **1100a** and **1100b**, display a setting for the one or more user-defined acoustic parameters that causes at least one playback device (represented by playback device icon **910a**) within the group of the one or more playback devices (represented by playback device icons **910a-910e**) to play back the particular media content in a different manner than another playback device of the group of the one or more playback devices. One will appreciate that additional or alternative embodiments may display configurations for the volume, balance, fade, and other acoustic parameters of each speaker.

[0163] Playback mode interfaces **1100a** and **1100b** also provide a user with the ability to enable or disable individual routines **922(a-d)** within the sleep playback mode. For example, in playback mode interfaces **1100a** and **1100b** routine **922d** has been disabled. In some embodiments, the routines **922(a-d)** are executed as an ordered set. As such, the first routine **922a** will be executed, followed by the second routine **922b**, and then followed by the third routine **922c**. Because the fourth routine **922d** has been disabled, the one or more playback devices **110** will stop executing

the one or more routines after the third routine **922c** completes execution or the ordered set of routines will start over with the first routine **922a**.

[0164] The playback mode interfaces **1200a** and **1200b** of FIG. **12A** and FIG. **12B** also allows a user to set a trigger condition field **930** for the sleep playback mode. The user is also able to associate sets of individual quickstart routines **1210(a-c)** with individual playback devices. In this exemplary playback mode interface **1200a**, a user is able to modify or create a quickstart routine within a routine editing space **1220** of the interface. When a user selects a particular routine from the sets of quickstart routines **1210(a-c)**, the routine editing space **1220** is populated with information from the selected routine. The user can then modify or create a routine for association with the particular playback device **110**. These playback mode interfaces **1200a** and **1200b** allow a user to associate specific routines, and in turn behaviors, with individual playback devices **110** when the playback devices **110** are in sleep playback mode.

[0165] In some embodiments, playback mode interface **1200b** comprises three different rendered views **1230(a-c)**. Rendered view **1230a** provides a user with options for executing and accessing the different sets of quickstart routines **1210a** and **1210b**. Rendered view **1230b** displays icons associated with individual playback device **910(a-c)**. The rendered view **1200b** also indicates a number of quickstart routines that are associated with each playback device. If a user selects the icon associated with individual playback device **910a** (i.e., “Bedroom-Mary”), the third rendered view **1230c** is displayed.

[0166] Rendered view **1230c** displays the set of quickstart routines **1210a** associated with the playback device, “Bedroom-Mary.” A user is provided with the ability to select each individual quickstart routine and change the media content, volume level, and various other settings associated with the quickstart routine. Additionally, the rendered view **1230c** provides a user with the ability to interact with a trigger condition field **930**. In the depicted embodiment, the trigger condition field **930** provides the user with the ability to set a time when the associate playback mode is entered and when it is exited. Other settings may provide a user with the ability to configure trigger conditions that are not related to time.

[0167] The playback mode interfaces **1300a** and **1300b** of FIGS. **13A** and **13B** allow a user to set personalized quickstart routines **922(a-c)** that can be executed within the sleep playback mode. In playback mode interfaces **1300a** and **1300b**, each quickstart routine **922(a-c)** is associated with the specific playback devices that it will be executed on (as shown by the playback icons **910(a-c)**). As the control device **130** or playback device **110** received user interactions the routines advance sequentially through the routines **922a**, **922b**, and **922c**.

[0168] For example, playback mode interfaces **1300a** and **1300b** can display a representation of a first playback mode (i.e., the sleep playback mode) and a set of routines **922(a-c)** associated with the first playback mode. The playback mode interfaces **1300a** and **1300b** can then receive a selection of the first routine **922a**, and in response, display playback settings associated with the first routine **922a**. The playback settings may comprise a name **1310** of the first routine **922a** and particular media content **1320** associated with the first routine **922a**.

[0169] The playback mode interfaces **1300a** and **1300b** may then receive a first user input changing the particular media content from a first media content to a second media content. For example, a user may change from “Seattle Rainfall” to “Ocean Sounds.” After receiving the first user input changing the particular media content, the control device **130** transmits, via a communication interface, a first message to update the playback settings associated with the first routine. The first message may be transmitted to one or more playback devices and/or a cloud network **102**.

[0170] After transmitting the first message, the control device **130** receives one or more user inputs to select a playback device **110** and/or to initiate the first routine. In response to receiving the one or more user inputs, the control device **130** transmits, via the communication interface, a second message to initiate the first routine on the first playback device **110**. The corresponding one or more playback devices **110** would then play back the media content “Ocean Sounds.” Once a user

has finished modifying or creating the routines, or scenes, the control device **130** may communicate the routines to a remote server for storage and/or further processing.

[0171] For example, a user may press a skip button on the one or more playback devices **110**. The skip button press may constitute a trigger condition. In response to the skip button press, the playback device may execute the “skip” command locally, communicate a “skip” universal plug and play (“uPNP”) command through the local network, through an API directly to the control device **130** via a network, or through an API to a cloud network **102** or to the control device **130**. After receiving the indication of the trigger condition, the control device **130** may communicate the executable instructions to the playback device **110** for final execution or may communicate through an API to the playback device **110** and cause the playback device to act in a manner defined by the executable instructions.

[0172] A control device **130** may then receive one or more second user inputs to activate the particular routine. For example, the control device **130** may receive an indication that a user has pressed a start button that is associated with a first routine within a particular playback mode. After receiving the one or more second user inputs, the control device **130** may transmit a message that causes the appropriate playback devices **110** to playback the particular media content that is defined by the one or more routines in accordance with the one or more media content settings.

[0173] FIG. **14** shows a schematic diagram of another playback mode user interface **1400**. In some embodiments, the playback mode user interface **1400** may be rendered on a control device **130**, such as a smartphone. Rendered view **1410** comprises a prompt **1430** to a user to enter a sleep playback mode. The prompt **1400** may be generated based upon an occurrence of a trigger condition. For example, the user may have previously indicated that the sleep playback mode should begin at 10 PM. The control device **130** may determine that the time is 10 PM and in response display prompt **1430** to the user to enter the sleep playback mode. In some embodiments, the prompt **1430** is only displayed if a user is interacting with a control device **130** during the occurrence of the trigger condition. Otherwise, the playback mode may automatically activate based upon the occurrence of the trigger condition.

[0174] In response to seeing the prompt, a user may activate the sleep playback mode by tapping the prompt **1400**. Additionally or alternatively, the user may activate the sleep playback mode by swiping down (as indicated by arrow **1450**) on the “My Sonos” page **1440**. In contrast, the user may dismiss the prompt and avoid activating the sleep playback mode by swiping up in a direction opposite of arrow **1450**. One will appreciate that the user interface interactions described above are provided for the sake of example and explanation. Additional or alternative interactions may be used to activate a playback mode.

[0175] Rendered view **1420** depicts a playback mode user interface **1400** that displays configuration information about a playback mode. Rendered view **1420** may be displayed in response to a user activating the sleep playback mode in rendered view **1410**. Rendered view **1420** includes a settings portion **1460** that allows a user to adjust trigger conditions associated with the sleep playback mode and a toggle to activate or deactivate the sleep playback mode. Rendered view **1420** also displays icons associated with each quickstart routine **1470a**, **1470b** within the sleep playback mode. In some embodiments, a user can individually activate a particular quickstart routine **1470a**, **1470b** by selecting the quickstart routine in rendered view **1420**. Additionally or alternatively, a user may be able to configure a quickstart routine **1470a**, **1470b** by selecting the quickstart routine in rendered view **1420**.

[0176] FIG. **15A** and FIG. **15B** show a schematic diagram of another playback mode user interface **1500**. Rendered view **1510** comprises a browse page that allows a user to select between a number of different services and playback device experiences. One of the listed experiences, comprises a “Sonos Sleep” experience **1512** which is associated with a sleep playback mode.

[0177] Upon selecting the “Sonos Sleep” experience **1512**, rendered view **1520** is displayed to the user. Rendered view **1520** comprises a “Nighttime Mode” portion **1522**, a “Quickstarts” portion

1524, and a “Wake Alarms” portion **1526**. In the depicted embodiment, rendered view **1520** also includes various media content options **1528** for a user to access. The depicted “Nighttime Mode” portion **1522** displays information about the trigger conditions associated with the sleep playback mode (i.e., “9:00 PM-6:00 AM”) and information about the rooms that are affected by the sleep playback mode (i.e., “5 Rooms”). The “Quickstarts” portion **1524** displays information about the quickstart routines associated with the sleep playback mode (i.e., “5 Quickstarts”). The “Wake Alarms” portion **1526** displays information about the alarms associated with the sleep playback mode (i.e., “6 Alarms”).

[0178] If a user selects the “Nighttime Mode” portion **1522**, rendered view **1530** is displayed. Rendered page **1530** displays a visual depiction of a playback device **110a** and a visual depiction of a user interaction **1532** on the playback device **110a**. The user interaction **1532** may be displayed to indicate to a user that performing the displayed user interaction **1532** on a playback device **110a** causes the sleep playback mode to advance between quickstart routines (e.g., a swipe across the top of the playback device). In some embodiments, the visual depiction of the playback device **110a** is adjusted to match a particular playback device **110** that the user owns, has most recently interacted with, is most commonly interacted with within the sleep playback mode, or is otherwise associated with the user's current actions.

[0179] Rendered view **1530** provides a settings portion **1534** that allows a user to toggle on or off the “Nighttime Mode” (also referred to herein as a “sleep playback mode”), adjust the rooms that are associated with the sleep playback mode, and/or adjust the trigger conditions associated with the sleep playback mode (e.g., in this case the enter time of 9:00 PM and the exit time of 6:00 AM). Using these settings, a user can customize the playback devices that are associated with a playback mode (in the depicted embodiment, on a per-room basis) and the trigger conditions that affect the playback mode.

[0180] Returning to rendered view **1520**, if a user selects the “Quickstarts” portion **1524**, rendered view **1540** of FIG. **15B** is displayed. Rendered view **1540** displays a list of quickstart routines **1542(a-d)** that are associated with the sleep playback mode. Rendered view **1540** also displays an option for adding quickstarts **1544**. In some embodiments, selecting a particular quickstart routine from the list of quickstart routines **1542(a-d)** causes the quickstart routine to be executed. In some embodiments, selecting a particular quickstart routine from the list of quickstart routines **1542(a-d)** causes a user interface to display settings and options associated with the quickstart routine. In some embodiments, a first type of interaction with a particular quickstart routine causes the particular quickstart routine to be executed, while a second type of interaction with a particular quickstart routine causes a user interface to display settings and options associated with the quickstart routine. For example, the first type of interaction may comprise a tap on a touch interface while the second type of interaction may comprise a long press.

[0181] Returning again to rendered view **1530**, if a user selects the “Wake Alarms” portion **1526**, rendered view **1550** of FIG. **15B** is displayed. Rendered view **1540** displays various trigger conditions **1552** in the form of alarms that are associated with the sleep playback mode. Each of the depicted trigger conditions also displays information relating to the frequency of the trigger condition, the speaker(s) associated with each individual trigger condition, and the media content associated with each trigger condition. As depicted, in some embodiments, a single playback mode can be associated with multiple different trigger conditions that cause different subsets of playback devices to behave independently and differently from each other. For example, in the depicted playback mode every day at 6:00 AM one speaker will playback “Sports Radio” media content, and then at 6:30 AM two speakers will playback “Daily News” media content. In some embodiments, selecting a particular trigger condition within rendered view **1530** allows a user to change the settings associated with the trigger condition.

[0182] FIG. **16** is schematic diagram of media playback system **100** in communication with cloud services **1600**, **1614**. In some embodiments, cloud network **102** comprises cloud services **1600**,

1614. The depicted embodiment comprises a control device **130**, a playback device **110**, a routine service **1600**, and a playback device service **1614**. The control device **130** may be within the same local area network as the playback device **110** or remote to the playback device **110**.

[0183] The playback device service **1614** provides network services for playback devices **110** and control devices **130** within a media playback system **100**. The playback device service **1614** may be executed on a remote server and/or executed by local devices, such as control devices **130** and playback devices **110**. For example, in some embodiments, a particular playback device **110a** within a group of playback devices **110** may be designated as a “group coordinator.” The group coordinator is tasked with receiving commands directed towards the group of playback devices **110** and communicating commands to group members. For example, the group coordinator may receive a command that is configured to cause a subset of playback devices within the group of playback devices **110** to playback particular media content. After receiving the command, the group coordinator sends out the commands to the subset of playback devices over the local area network. As an additional example, a user may tap a volume up button on a particular group member of the group of playback devices **110**. The particular group member sends the volume up command instruction to the group coordinator over the local area network. In response, the group coordinator increases volume up for itself and sends out an instruction, over the local area network, to all group members to increase volume. In some embodiments, playback devices and control devices may belong to common group, and either a playback device or a control device can function as a group coordinator.

[0184] In some embodiments the playback device service **1614** comprises local network services such as uPNP or other local network APIs. The playback device service **1614** may communicate commands and information between playback devices **110** and control devices **130**. For instance, a particular trigger condition may comprise user interaction with a control surface on a playback device **110a**. The playback device **110a** may be bonded to other playback devices and/or a member of a zone, or group. In response to the user interaction, the playback device **110a** communicates with the playback device service **1614** which communicates to any other bonded playback devices or playback devices **110** within the same zone or group.

[0185] In some embodiment, routines are decoded by a routine decoder **1602** running at the routine service **1600**. The routine decoder **1602** may comprise purpose-built hardware and/or executable software that is configured to translate the routines from a first form to a second form. For example, the routine decoder **1602** may translate inputs provided by a user in a configuration interface **900** into a routine that is at least partially executable. In some embodiment, variables are inserted into the partially decoded routine at the time of translation or at some other time after the routine is partially decoded. The routine decoder **1602** may generate instructions that are executable at a control device **130**, at a routine service **1600**, at a playback device **110**, at a playback device service **1614** or at some other device within a media playback system **100**. In some embodiments, the decoding is stateless and utilizes the routines database **1604** for base definitions and a hardcoded mapping to the commands that are executable at the one or more playback devices **110**. As used herein, unless specified otherwise, a “routine” refers to routines that have not been encoded, routines that have been encoded, and routines that have been partially encoded.

[0186] In the embodiment depicted in FIG. **16**, the one or more routines are executed **1620** by one or more processors at the playback device **110**. The playback device **110** may receive a routine trigger **1622** from a control device **130**, from the playback device service **1614**, through direct interaction with the playback device **110** itself, or from the routine service **1600**. One or more playback devices **110** may also comprise a database of decoded routine instructions **1624**.

[0187] In some embodiments, each playback device **110** within a media playback system **100** comprise the database of decoded routine instructions **1624**. In contrast, in some embodiments only a portion of the playback devices **110** within the media playback system **100** comprise the database of decoded routine instructions **1624**. For example, in some embodiments, one or more playback

devices **110** function as caches for other playback devices **110** within the media playback system **100**. For example, 'RHTTPCache' may be utilized for edge-cache management. In such a configuration the playback device service **1614** functions to communicate routines between the playback devices **110** that do not comprise the database of decoded routine instructions **1624**. Further, in some embodiments, the routines are executed by the one or more playback devices **110** that comprise the database of decoded routine instructions **1624**. Those playback devices **110** then communicate commands through the playback device service **1614** directly to the other playback devices **110** to cause them to perform the commands from the routines.

[0188] In some embodiments, the routine definitions are stored in the routine services **1600** cloud network. In this embodiment, the routines are not executed directly by the routine services **1600** cloud network, nor are the routines accessed directly by the playback devices **110**. Instead, the routines are decoded by the routine decoder **1602** into an intermediate routine comprising an executable instruction or a pointer to an executable instruction stored at the playback device **110** and a data structure, such as a JSON data structure, representing the executable instruction's parameters. This routine decoder **1602** may then communicate the decoded routine (i.e., the intermediate routine) to one playback device **110a**. The playback device **110a** may then store the decoded routine within the database of decoded routine instructions **1624** and communicate, through the playback device service **1614**, the decoded routine to other playback devices **110** within the media playback system **100**.

[0189] In some embodiments, the routine service **1600** serves as the source of truth for the routines within a media playback system **100**. As such in some embodiments, the playback devices **110** and/or the control devices **130** communicate with the routine service **1600** to verify that they have the most up-to-date routines. In response, the routine service **1600** may communicate a single hash of all the decoded routines that are associated with a given media playback system to the requesting device. For instance, the routine service **1600** may generate a new hash of all of the decoded routines stored within its routines database **1604** for a given media playback system **100**. When a device associated with that media playback system **100** queries the routine service **1600**, the routine service **1600** communicates the hash to the device. The device then compares the received hash to a hash that the device generated for the routines stored within the database of decoded routine instructions **1624**. If the hashes do not match, the device requests updated routines from the routine service **1600**.

[0190] In contrast, in some embodiments, the routine service **1600** generates a unique hash for each decoded routine that it sends to a media playback system **100**. The unique hashes are stored in the routines database **1604** with the routines. The routine service **1600** may communicate these hashes to a device (e.g., playback device) within a media playback system **100**. The device can then compare hashes of routines that are stored within the database of decoded routines instructions **1624** with the received hashes. If any hashes do not match, the playback devices **110** request the routines associated with the mismatched hashes.

[0191] In some embodiments, the playback devices **110** and/or control devices **130** are configured to periodically query the routine service **1600** to verify the status of their routines. Additionally or alternatively, in some embodiments, the routine services **1600** is configured to send a notification to the playback devices **110** and/or control devices **130** when an update occurs within the routines database **1604**.

[0192] Additionally, in some embodiments, prior to executing a routine, playback devices **110** are configured to first verify the status of the routines stored within the database of decoded routines instructions **1624**. If the playback devices **110** are not able to connect to the routine service **1600**, the playback devices **110** may query other devices within the media playback system **100**. The other devices may communicate one or more hashes associated with the routines that they have respectively stored. If the hashes match, the playback devices **110** may proceed with executing the routine. Additionally or alternatively, if the playback devices **110** are not able to contact the routine

services **1600**, the playback devices **110** may communicate a message to a user that the routines are not available.

[0193] As discussed above, in some embodiments, one or more playback devices **110** implement local-area network cache for the routines. In some embodiments, a control device **130** may request updates for routines from the cache that is implemented by the one or more playback devices **110**. The cache may comprise data stored within the database of decoded routine instructions **1624**.

[0194] FIG. **17A** is a message flow diagram of a media playback system **100** in communication with a cloud service as depicted in FIG. **16**. FIG. **17A** depicts initial communications between a control device **130**, a routine service **1600**, and one or more playback devices **110** within a media playback system **100**. An initial communication **1700** comprises a control device **130** requesting a list of playback modes or routines (also referred to as scenes) from the decoded routines database **1624** (also referred to as the “database of decoded routines instructions **1624**”) at the one or more playback devices **110**.

[0195] In some embodiments, communication **1700** comprises an identification associated (e.g., account ID, user ID, household ID, system ID) with the particular playback system **100** and a request for a “RoutineList” that is associated with the identification. In some embodiments, each routine is associated with its own routine ID that can be used within a playback system **100** to track and identify specific routines. For example, a playback device **110** may request an entire list of routines associated with a particular user or household by communicating a user ID or household ID to routines service **1600**. Similarly, a playback device **110** may be able to request a single routine from the routines service **1600** by communicating a routine ID associated with the desired routine. In some embodiments, to request a particular routine, a playback device **110** communicates a user ID or a household ID along with the routine ID to the routine service **1600**. The routine service **1600** uses the user ID or household ID to identify the correct set of routines, and then uses the routine ID to select the correct routine. Additionally or alternatively, in some embodiments, communication **1700** comprises an identification associated with the particular playback system **100**, a request for a “RoutineList” that is associated with the identification, and a “Type” variable that indicates the type of routines that are being requested. For instance, the particular playback system **100** may be associated with multiple different users, each with their own routines. Each user may be represented by a different “Type” variable that allows communication **1700** to request the specific routines associated with a particular user. The “Type” variable may also be associated with sets of routines for specific zones, groups, geographic locations, playback device configurations (e.g., bonded pairs, home theater system, etc.), usage context (e.g., commercial, business, hotel, restaurant), and other types of groupings.

[0196] In response to communication **1700**, the one or more playback devices **110** send a communication **1702** to the routine service **1600** to request the current routines stored by the routine services **1600** within the routine database **1604**. As explained above, communication **1702** may be requesting a verification, such as a hash, to verify that the routines stored in the decoded routines database **1624** are up-to-date. Additionally or alternatively, communication **1702** may be requesting that the routine service **1600** communicate all or a portion of the routines in the routines database **1604** to the one or more playback devices **110**.

[0197] In response to communication **1702**, the routine service **1600** sends communication **1704** to the one or more playback devices **110**. In the case that communication **1704** comprises a validation, such as a hash, the playback devices **110** verifies that the routines stored in the decoded routines database **1624** are up-to-date. If the routines are determined to not be up-to-date, the one or more playback devices **110** request the necessary routines in order to update the routines stored within the decoded routines database **1624**. In the case that communication **1704** comprises decoded routines, the one or more playback devices **110** store the decoded routines within the decoded routines database **1624**.

[0198] Additionally, the one or more playback devices **110** send communication **1706** to the control

devices. In some embodiments, communication **1624** comprises descriptions and/or names of the routines but does not include executable instructions. In contrast, in some embodiments, communication **1624** comprises the decoded routines with their associated executable instructions. [0199] FIG. **17B** depicts communications between a control device **130**, a routine service **1600**, and one or more playback devices **110** related to creating or editing a routine within a media playback system **100**. Communication **1710** is generated by the control device **130** in response to a user editing or creating a routine. The process for editing or creating routines is described above with respect to FIGS. **9A-9D**.

[0200] As an example, a user may provide the following intents while creating or editing a routine on the control device **130**: (1) Set initial volume to 20, (2) Start playing Sleep Playback Mode: The Neighbor's Dog Finally Shut Up, (3) Ramp volume to 5 over the next 30 minutes, and (4) Stop after 60 minutes (from when content playback started). The control device **130** maps these user intents to a data structure that is communicable within the playback system **100**. For example, the control device **130** may generate a JSON data structure in the following form: {"id": <something_generated>, "contentUri": "x-sonosapi-radio:sonos%3a1234", "initialVol":20, "rampToVol":5, "rampToVolOverTime":30, "duration":60}.

[0201] Communication **1710** is sent to the playback device **110** for initial storage in the decoded routines database **1624**. In some embodiments, a newly created or modified routine has not yet been decoded, so the newly created or modified routine is stored at the playback device **110** until decoding is complete.

[0202] After receiving communication **1710**, the one or more playback devices **110** send communication **1712** to the routine service **1600**. Communication **1712** may comprise the routine or a description of the routine as provided by the control devices **130**. For example, communication **1712** may comprise the JSON structure described above, the user intents described above, or some other data structure describing or configured to implement the user intents. In some embodiments, the control device **130** may further configure the data structure received in communication **1710** before sending it to the routines service **1600**. For example, the control device **130** may be a group coordinator for a group of playback devices. The control device **130** may add information to the data structure relating to other group members, such as bonded playback devices **110**.

[0203] Message **1714** comprises an internal message within the routines service **1600**. In particular, message **1714** is sent by the routine services **1600** to the routine decoder **1602** for decoding. During decoding, the routines service **1600** may process the received data structure and add commands and information specific to the playback system **100** that will be executing the routine. For example, routine services **1600** may add information relating to groups, group coordinators, bonded playback devices, and other similar information to the routine.

[0204] In some embodiments, the decoding is stateless and utilizes the routines database **1604** for base definitions and a hardcoded mapping to the commands that are executable at the one or more playback devices **110**. Accordingly, the routines services **1600** may decode the routine by analyzing the data structure and mapping information within the data structure to commands within the routines database **1604**. For instance, the data structure may comprise an entry of "rampToVolOverTime":30". The routines service **1600** may map the data entry "rampToVolOverTime" to a particular command or set of commands for adjusting volume at one or more playback devices **110** over time. The routines service **1600** may further map the variable "30" to the same particular command or set of commands. As such, in some embodiments, the routines services **1600** decoding function comprises mapping information within the data structure received in communication **1712** to commands and variables stored within the routines database **1604** and generating a resulting routine that is executable at a playback device **110**.

[0205] Once the routine has been transformed into a decoded routine, the routine service **1600** sends communication **1716** to the playback device. Communication **1716** may comprise the decoded routine. In some embodiments, the decoded routine comprises an ordered list of

commands that are executable by one or more playback devices **110**. For example, the decoded routine may comprise an ordered list of (1) a command to set a particular volume, (2) specific content to play, (3) a command to ramp volume, (4) a command to load a particular queue from the cloud. In an additional or alternative embodiment, the decoded routine may comprise executable code that is directly executable by one or more playback devices.

[0206] After receiving communication **1716**, the one or more playback devices **110** stores the decoded routine within the decoded routines database **1624**. The one or more playback devices **110** may also delete the newly created or modified routine that had been received in message **1710**.

[0207] Message **1718** comprise an internal communication with the one or more playback devices **110**. In particular, after receiving the decoded routine the one or more playback devices **110** generate a file to be shared within a local cache or to be shared with other playback devices **110** and/or control devices **130** within the media playback system **100**. The generated file may be communicated through the one or more playback devices **110** pushing the updated file to the other playback devices **110** and/or control devices **130** or the other playback devices **110** and/or control devices **130** may query the one or more playback devices **110** for the file. Additional details regarding caching and sharing data within playback system **100** can be found, for example, in U.S. Pat. No. 10,747,493, which was incorporated by reference above.

[0208] In view of the above, one of skill in the art will appreciate that in some embodiments the control device **130** may send communication **1710** directly to the routines service **1600**. The routines service **1600** may then decode **1714** the received routine and communicate the executable routine **1716** to the playback devices **110**.

[0209] FIG. **17C** depicts communications between a control device **130**, a routine service **1600**, and one or more playback devices **110** in response to detecting a trigger condition within a media playback system **100**. In this embodiment, control device **130** generates communication **1720** in response to detecting a trigger condition. However, in view of the disclosure, one will appreciate that this is merely exemplary and that trigger conditions can be detected by the routine service **1600** or by the one or more playback devices **110**. Communication **1720** is sent to the routines trigger function **1622** within the one or more playback devices **110**.

[0210] The routines trigger function **1622** associates the detected trigger condition with a particular routine. In some embodiments, the particular routine comprises a routine associated with a playback mode, which when executed causes the one or more playback devices **110** to enter the playback mode. Additionally, in some embodiments, the routines trigger function **1622** accesses a list that associates different trigger functions with different routines.

[0211] The routine trigger function **1622** sends communication **1722** to the routines execution function **1620**. Communication **1722** may comprise an identifier for the routine that is associated with the detected trigger condition. After receiving communication **1722**, the routines execution function **1620** sends communication **1724** to the decoded routines database **1624**. Communication **1722** may comprise an identifier for the desired routine. After receiving communication **1724**, the decoded routines database **1624** sends the decoded routine to the routines execution function **1620** within communication **1726**.

[0212] After receiving the communication **1726**, the routine execution function **1620** sends communication **1728** to the routine service **1600**. Communication **1728** may comprise instructions that the particular routine has been executed. Communication **1728** may allow third-party devices to respond to the execution of routines within the media playback system **100**. For example, third-party devices may also be in communication, through an API, with the routine service **1600**. Third-party devices may be able to register with the routine service **1600** in relation to particular routines. For instance, a user may be able to dim her bedroom lights with a routine. When the routine was executed by the routines execution function **1620**, message **1028** would communicate the execution of the routine to the routine service **1600**. Software associated with the third-party light system within the user's room would then receive a notification that the routine had been executed. In

response, the third-party light system could cause the lights in the user's bedroom to dim.

[0213] After sending message **1728**, the routines execution function **1620** performs a variable substitution in message **1730**. Specifically, the decoded routines stored in the decoded routines database **1624** may be configured to allow for variable substitution by the executing one or more playback devices **110**. The variable substitution may relate to variables that are local to the one or more playback devices **110**, such as configurations of the one or more playback devices **110** and/or configurations of the media playback system **100**.

[0214] Message **1732** represents the execution of the decoded routine by the routines execution function **1620**. Once execution has completed, the routines execution function **1620** communicates message **1734** to the routines service **1600**. Message **1734** comprises a message to the routine service **1600** that the execution of the particular routine has completed. Similar to message **1728**, this information may be utilized by third-party devices to integrate with the media playback system **100**. For instance, upon receiving a notification that the particular routine has completed, the third-party light system may cause the user's bedroom lights to return to their original brightness level.

[0215] FIG. **18** shows a schematic diagram of a media playback system where the routines are executed by the routine service **1600**. In some embodiments, the one or more playback devices **110** comprise a routines trigger function **1622** that detect the occurrence of a trigger condition at the one or more playback devices **110**. For example, the routine trigger function **1622** can detect when a user interacts with a user interface at the one or more playback devices **110** in a way that triggers a routine.

[0216] When a trigger condition is detected by the one or more playback devices **110** or by the control device **130**, the trigger condition is communicated to the routine service **1600** for processing. Once a trigger condition is received, the routine service **1600** identifies the associated routine in the routines database **1604**. The routines execution function **1800** then executes the routines directly within the routine service **1600**. Commands that are related to the routine are issued by the routine service **1600** directly to the one or more playback devices **110** or to the playback device service **1614**, which then communicates the commands to the one or more playback devices **110**. Upon receiving and executing the commands, the one or more playback devices **110** store metadata related to the routine in a routine metadata database **1810**. One will appreciate that in this embodiment, the processing power used to execute the routines is hosted at the routine service **1600**, which may comprise one or more servers. As such, the one or more playback devices **110** are protected from a potentially heavy processing load that may be associated with executing routines locally.

[0217] In some embodiments, the routine execution function **1620**, **1800** may be hosted by the control device **130**. The control device **130** may then execute one or more routines and communicate commands directly to the one or more playback devices **110** and/or routine service **1600**. Additionally or alternatively, once a user has finished modifying or creating the routines, or scenes, the control device **130** may communicate the routines to a remote server for storage and/or further processing. In some embodiments, the one or more routines are executed at least in part by the one or more playback devices **110**, at least in part by the control device **130**, or at least in part by server that is remote to the control device. For instance, the control device **130** may be configured to generate executable instructions from the routines by at least partially decoding the routines using at least one processor at the control device **130**. Further, the control device **130** may be configured to communicate the executable instructions (also referred to herein at “decoded routines” or “intermediate routine”) to the appropriate playback device **110** in response to receiving an indication of a trigger condition.

[0218] FIG. **19** shows a flow diagram **1900** for operating a playback device **110** within a playback mode. At step **1910** the playback device **110** receives a playback mode indication. At step **1920**, after receiving a playback mode indication, the playback device **110** is caused to operate within a particular playback mode. FIGS. **8A** and **8B**, among other portions of this disclosure, depict a

playback device **110** operating within a particular playback mode.

[0219] At step **1930** after initiating operation of the particular playback mode, the playback device **110** accesses a particular set of routines that is associated with the particular playback mode. The particular set of routines are configured such that when they are executed, they cause the playback device to play back particular media content with a particular user-defined acoustic parameter. Additionally, the particular set of routines are configured such that when they are executed, they configure the playback device to advance between one or more routines within the particular set of routines in response to one or more user interface interactions. For example, FIGS. **8A** and **8B** depicts an ordered set of routines **820(a-f)** that may cause the playback devices **110** to play media content. Additionally, FIGS. **8A** and **8B** depict a user interface interaction **830** that causes the playback device **110** to advance between different routines.

[0220] At step **1940**, the playback device **110** receives the one or more user interface interactions at a user interface associated with the playback device **110**. For example, in FIG. **8B** the playback device **110** receives the one or more user interface interactions **830** at a user interface (e.g., the control surface **313**) in the form of a button swipe.

[0221] At step **1950**, the playback device **110** executes at least one routine selected from the particular set of routines. In some embodiments, the playback device **110** will sequentially execute each routine within an ordered set of routines. Additionally, or alternatively, the control device may receive an additional user interface interaction which causes the playback device **110** to advance sequentially to the next routine within the ordered set of routines.

[0222] FIG. **20** shows a flow diagram **2000** for configuring a playback mode at a control device **130**. At step **162010**, the control device **130** receives, via a configuration interface **900**, one or more first user inputs associating a particular routine with a particular playback mode and associating the particular playback mode with one or more playback devices **110**. For example, FIGS. **9A-9E** depict various different configuration interfaces **900(a-e)** that illustrate different examples of associating routines with playback modes and playback modes with playback devices **110**.

[0223] At step **2020**, the control device **130** receives an indication of a particular media content to associate with the particular routine. For example, in FIG. **9A** a first routine **922a** is associated with the media content of “Seattle Rainfall.” At step **2030**, the control device **130** receive one or more user-defined acoustic parameters for the particular media content. The one or more user-defined acoustic parameters are configured to cause the one or more playback devices to play back the particular media content in accordance with the one or more user-defined acoustic parameters. For example, in FIG. **9A** the configuration interface **900a** provides options for a user to set one or more exemplary user-defined acoustic parameters related to the “volume” and “rain speed” of the “Seattle Rainfall” media content.

[0224] At step **2040**, the control device **130** associates a particular trigger condition with the particular routine. The particular trigger condition comprises a condition that causes the particular routine to be executed. For example, in FIG. **9A** a trigger condition field **930a** allows a user to set an alarm that will cause the triggering of the first routine within the playback mode. One will appreciate, however, that the setting of the alarm is merely exemplary and that additional or alternative embodiments may allow a user to set a particular button press, a geolocation, or a number of other trigger conditions.

[0225] At step **2050**, the control device **130** transmits, via the communication interface, the particular routine to a server remote from the control device **130**. For example, in FIG. **17B** the control device **130** communicates routines to the routine services **1600**. At step **2060**, the control device **130** receives one or more second user inputs to activate the particular routine. For example, in FIG. **8B** the one or more playback devices **110** receives the one or more user interface interactions **830** (also referred to herein as “user interface inputs”) at a user interface (e.g., the control surface **313**) in the form of a button swipe.

[0226] After receiving the one or more second user inputs, at step **2070** the control device **130**

transmits a message that causes the one or more playback devices **110** to play back the particular media content according to the one or more user-defined acoustic parameters. For example, in FIGS. **10-12** different examples are depicted of the control device **130** communicating messages that cause the one or more playback devices **110** to play back the particular media content according to the one or more user-defined acoustic parameters.

V. Conclusion

[0227] The above discussions relating to playback devices, controller devices, playback zone configurations, and media content sources provide only some examples of operating environments within which functions and methods described below may be implemented. Other operating environments and configurations of media playback systems, playback devices, and network devices not explicitly described herein may also be applicable and suitable for implementation of the functions and methods.

[0228] As discussed above, playback modes may comprise sets of routines that cause one or more playback devices to function in specified manners. In particular, the playback modes may cause user interfaces to operate in a specific manner that causes the one or more playback devices to advance within a given set of routines. As discussed above, a variety of different devices and intermediary devices may perform communication functions, decoding functions, execution functions, configuration functions, and other functions related to the routines and playback modes.

[0229] The description above discloses, among other things, various example systems, methods, apparatus, and articles of manufacture including, among other components, firmware and/or software executed on hardware. It is understood that such examples are merely illustrative and should not be considered as limiting. For example, it is contemplated that any or all of the firmware, hardware, and/or software aspects or components can be embodied exclusively in hardware, exclusively in software, exclusively in firmware, or in any combination of hardware, software, and/or firmware. Accordingly, the examples provided are not the only ways) to implement such systems, methods, apparatus, and/or articles of manufacture.

[0230] Additionally, references herein to “embodiment” means that a particular feature, structure, or characteristic described in connection with the embodiment can be included in at least one example embodiment of an invention. The appearances of this phrase in various places in the specification are not necessarily all referring to the same embodiment, nor are separate or alternative embodiments mutually exclusive of other embodiments. As such, the embodiments described herein, explicitly and implicitly understood by one skilled in the art, can be combined with other embodiments.

[0231] The specification is presented largely in terms of illustrative environments, systems, procedures, steps, logic blocks, processing, and other symbolic representations that directly or indirectly resemble the operations of data processing devices coupled to networks. These process descriptions and representations are typically used by those skilled in the art to most effectively convey the substance of their work to others skilled in the art. Numerous specific details are set forth to provide a thorough understanding of the present disclosure. However, it is understood to those skilled in the art that certain embodiments of the present disclosure can be practiced without certain, specific details. In other instances, well known methods, procedures, components, and circuitry have not been described in detail to avoid unnecessarily obscuring aspects of the embodiments. Accordingly, the scope of the present disclosure is defined by the appended claims rather than the foregoing description of embodiments.

[0232] When any of the appended claims are read to cover a purely software and/or firmware implementation, at least one of the elements in at least one example is hereby expressly defined to include a tangible, non-transitory medium such as a memory, DVD, CD, Blu-ray, and so on, storing the software and/or firmware.

Claims

1. A control device comprising: a communication interface; at least one processor; and at least one non-transitory computer-readable medium comprising program instructions that are executable by the at least one processor such that the control device is configured to: receive, via a configuration interface, one or more first user inputs associating a particular routine with a particular playback mode and associating the particular playback mode with one or more playback devices; receive an indication of a particular media content to associate with the particular routine; receive one or more user-defined acoustic parameters for the particular media content, wherein the one or more user-defined acoustic parameters are configured to cause the one or more playback devices to play back the particular media content in accordance with the one or more user-defined acoustic parameters; associate a particular trigger condition with the particular routine, wherein the particular trigger condition comprise a condition that causes the particular routine to be executed; transmit, via the communication interface, the particular routine to a server remote from the control device; receive one or more second user inputs to activate the particular routine; and after receiving the one or more second user inputs, transmit a message that causes the one or more playback devices to play back the particular media content according to the one or more user-defined acoustic parameters.
2. The control device of claim 1, wherein the program instructions that are executable by the at least one processor such that the control device is configured to receive, via the configuration interface, the one or more first user inputs associating the particular playback mode with the one or more playback devices comprises program instructions that are executable by the at least one processor such that the one or more playback devices are configured to: receive through the configuration interface the one or more first user inputs associating the particular playback mode with multiple playback devices, wherein the particular routine comprises: instructions that are configured to cause the multiple playback devices to play the particular media content, and one or more user-defined acoustic parameters that configure the multiple playback devices to play the particular media content in accordance with the one or more user-defined acoustic parameters.
3. The control device of claim 2, wherein the one or more user-defined acoustic parameters configure at least one playback devices selected from the multiple playback devices to play the particular media content in a different manner than at least one other playback device selected from the multiple playback devices.
4. The control device of claim 1, wherein the at least one non-transitory computer-readable medium further comprises program instructions that are executable by the at least one processor such that the control device is configured to: display, via the configuration interface, a single user interface entity representative of a group of the one or more playback devices, wherein the group of the one or more playback devices are configured to play back the particular media content in synchrony.
5. The control device of claim 4, wherein the program instructions that are executable by the at least one processor such that the one or more playback devices are configured to transmit a message that causes the one or more playback devices to playback the particular media content according to the one or more user-defined acoustic parameters comprises program instructions that are executable by the at least one processor such that the control device is configured to: transmit the message that causes the group of the one or more playback devices to playback the particular media content according to the one or more user-defined acoustic parameters.
6. The control device of claim 5, wherein the at least one non-transitory computer-readable medium further comprises program instructions that are executable by the at least one processor such that the control device is configured to: display, via the configuration interface, a setting for the one or more user-defined acoustic parameters that causes at least one play back device within the group of the one or more playback devices to play back the particular media content in a different manner than another playback device of the group of the one or more playback devices.

7. The control device of claim 1, wherein the at least one non-transitory computer-readable medium further comprises program instructions that are executable by the at least one processor such that the control device is configured to: generate executable instructions by at least partially decoding the particular routine using the at least one processor; and after receiving the particular trigger condition, communicate the executable instructions to the one or more playback devices.
8. The control device of claim 1, wherein the at least one non-transitory computer-readable medium further comprises program instructions that are executable by the at least one processor such that the control device is configured to: receive, via a configuration interface, one or more third user inputs associating multiple routines with the particular playback mode; and receive, via a configuration interface, one or more fourth user inputs ordering the multiple routines within an ordered set.
9. The control device of claim 1, wherein a particular trigger condition comprises the one or more second user inputs.
10. The control device of claim 1, wherein the particular routine is executed at least in part by the control device.
11. A computer-implemented method executed by a processor at a control device, the computer-implemented method comprising: receiving, via a configuration interface, one or more first user inputs associating a particular playback mode with one or more playback devices; receiving one or more user-defined acoustic parameters for particular media content that is associated with the particular playback mode, wherein the one or more user-defined acoustic parameters are configured to cause the one or more playback devices to play back the particular media content in accordance with the one or more user-defined acoustic parameters; associating a particular trigger condition with the particular playback mode, wherein the particular trigger condition comprise a condition that causes the particular playback mode to be executed; receiving one or more second user inputs to activate a particular routine, wherein the particular routine is associated with the particular playback mode; and after receiving the one or more second user inputs, transmitting a message that causes the one or more playback devices to play back the particular media content according to the one or more user-defined acoustic parameters.
12. The computer-implemented method of claim 11, further comprising: receiving through the configuration interface the one or more first user inputs associating the particular playback mode with multiple playback devices, wherein the particular routine comprises: instructions that are configured to cause the multiple playback devices to play the particular media content, and one or more user-defined acoustic parameters that configure the multiple playback devices to play the particular media content in accordance with the one or more user-defined acoustic parameters.
13. The computer-implemented method of claim 12, wherein the one or more user-defined acoustic parameters configure at least one playback devices selected from the multiple playback devices to play the particular media content in a different manner than at least one other playback device selected from the multiple playback devices.
14. The computer-implemented method of claim 11, further comprising: displaying, via the configuration interface, a single user interface entity representative of a group of the one or more playback devices, wherein the group of the one or more playback devices are configured to play back the particular media content in synchrony.
15. The computer-implemented method of claim 14, wherein transmitting a message that causes the one or more playback devices to playback the particular media content according to the one or more user-defined acoustic parameters further comprises: transmitting the message that causes the group of the one or more playback devices to playback the particular media content according to the one or more user-defined acoustic parameters.
16. The computer-implemented method of claim 15, further comprising: displaying, via the configuration interface, a setting for the one or more user-defined acoustic parameters that causes at least one play back device within the group of the one or more playback devices to playback the

particular media content in a different manner than another playback device of the group of the one or more playback devices.

17. The computer-implemented method of claim 11, further comprising: generating executable instructions by at least partially decoding the particular routine using at least one processor at the control device; and after receiving the particular trigger condition, communicating the executable instructions to the one or more playback devices.

18. The computer-implemented method of claim 11, further comprising: receiving, via a configuration interface, one or more third user inputs associating multiple routines with the particular playback mode; and receiving via a configuration interface, one or more fourth user inputs ordering the multiple routines within an ordered set.

19. The computer-implemented method of claim 11, wherein the particular routine is executed at least in part by the control device.

20. A non-transitory computer-readable storage media comprising computer-executable instructions that, when executed at a processor of a control device, cause the control device to: receive, via a configuration interface, one or more first user inputs associating a particular playback mode with one or more playback devices; receive one or more user-defined acoustic parameters for particular media content that is associated with the particular playback mode, wherein the one or more user-defined acoustic parameters are configured to cause the one or more playback devices to play back the particular media content in accordance with the one or more user-defined acoustic parameters; associate a particular trigger condition with the particular playback mode, wherein the particular trigger condition comprise a condition that causes the particular playback mode to be executed; receive one or more second user inputs to activate a particular routine, wherein the particular routine is associated with the particular playback mode; and after receiving the one or more second user inputs, transmit a message that causes the one or more playback devices to play back the particular media content according to the one or more user-defined acoustic parameters.
